

DEDICATED PRELIM PROGRAM(DPP)**UPSC-CSE PRELIMINARY TEST SERIES – 2021/2022****DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO****TEST BOOKLET SERIES****Test Code:****DPP****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST -06****E6****Time Allowed: Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET DOES NOT HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC.

2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE A, B, C OR D AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.

3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the provided alongside this line. DO NOT write anything else on the Test Booklet.

4. This Test Booklet contains 100 questions. Each question is printed in English. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose ONLY ONE response for each item.

5. All items carry equal marks.

6. Penalty for wrong answers:

THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BYA CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.

- I. There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, One-Third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
- II. If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
- III. If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.

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TOPICS COVERD: Union territory, Special status of states & Provision, Panchayats, Municipality NITI Aayog, National Development Council, National Human Right Commission, state Human Right Commission, CBI & CVC Lokpal and Lokayuktas State Information Commission Central Information Commission, Remaining miscellaneous topics



Q.1) Consider the following statements about National Human Rights Commission:

1. No sitting judge of the Supreme Court can be appointed as a member of the National Human Rights Commission.
2. Leader of Opposition in Rajya Sabha is one of the members of the selection committee for chairman and members.
3. Chairman of the Commission holds office for a fixed term of five years.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.2) Consider the following statements about National Human Rights Commission:

1. The Commission is not empowered to inquire into any matter after the expiry of one year from the date on which the act constituting violation of human rights is alleged to have been committed.
2. The chairman or any member of the Commission can be removed by the President on the ground of 'proved misbehaviour and incapacity' only.
3. The Commission is restricted from inquiring into any violation of human rights suo motu.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.3) Consider the following Amendments made by the Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019:

1. It increased the number of members, other than chairperson, of the National Human Rights Commission from three to five.
2. It provided for membership of a woman member having knowledge or practical experience with respect to human rights.
3. It provided that the Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities to be deemed to be an ex-officio member of the Commission.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.4) Consider the following statements about the National Human Rights Commission:

1. The Commission can intervene in any proceeding involving any allegation of violation of human rights pending before a court.
2. The Commission can recommend the government to make payment of compensation to the victim of human rights violation.
3. The Commission shall be informed by the central government about the action taken on its recommendations with respect to allegations of violation of human rights by armed forces within three months.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.5) Consider the following statements about State Human Rights Commission:

1. The Chairperson or a member of the Commission, after their tenure is ineligible for further employment under the Government of a State.
2. The Chairperson or a member of the Commission can be removed by the Governor of the State on the same ground as the chairperson or members of the National Human Rights Commission.
3. A State Human Rights Commission can inquire into violation of human rights only in respect of subjects mentioned in the State List of the Seventh schedule of the Constitution.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.6) Which of the following statements about the State Human Rights Commission is incorrect?

- a) Chairperson and members of the State Human Rights Commission can address their resignation to the Governor of the state concerned.
- b) Central Government can confer upon the State Human Rights Commission the functions relating to human rights violation in union territories.
- c) Two or more states can appoint a person as chairperson of the State Human Rights Commissions simultaneously.
- d) None of the above



Q.7) Which of the following statements about Lokpal is incorrect?

- a) A person of less than 45 years of age cannot become a chairperson of the Lokpal.
- b) Leader of Opposition in Rajya Sabha is one of the members of the select committee for appointment of chairperson of Lokpal.
- c) The appointment of a new chairperson should be done at least three months before the expiry of the term of the chairperson.
- d) The salary, allowance and other conditions of service of the chairperson are same as those of the Chief Justice of India.

Q.8) Consider the following statements about the Lokpal:

- 1. After ceasing to hold office, the Chairperson is ineligible for appointment as an administrator of a Union Territory.
- 2. At least fifty percent of members of Lokpal shall be from amongst the persons belonging to the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women only.
- 3. The Search Committee for the appointment of members should consist of at least seven members.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.9) Consider the following statements about the special provisions provided under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act for Prime Minister:

- 1. The Lokpal cannot inquire about any matter related with international relations and public order.
- 2. At least three-fourth of members of the full bench of Lokpal should consider the initiation of inquiry.
- 3. Inquiry into allegations of corruption against the Prime Minister should be held in camera and if the inquiry is dismissed, the records of the inquiry shall be made public.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.10) Consider the following statements about the Lokpal:

- 1. Only a Special Court constituted under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 can take cognizance of a false and frivolous complaint.
- 2. The Lokpal functions as appellate authority for appeals arising out of any delivery of public service by any public authority where the decision contains finding of corruption under the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988.
- 3. The Lokpal cannot inquire or investigate into any complaint, if the complaint is made after the expiry of seven years from the date on which the offence mentioned in the complaint is alleged to have been committed.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.11) Consider the following statements about Lokpal:

- 1. The Lokpal cannot inquire into any complaint made against the Chairperson or any member of Lokpal.
- 2. The Chairperson of the Lokpal can contest for the election of the President after a period of five years from the date of relinquishing the office.
- 3. Chairperson or any member of Lokpal can be removed by the President on the ground of 'proved misbehaviour and incapacity' after an inquiry held by the Supreme Court.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.12) Consider the following statements about Central Vigilance Commission:

- 1. The Chairperson and members of Central Vigilance Commission are appointed on the recommendations of a committee in which the Union Minister of Home Affairs is one of the members.
- 2. The salary, allowances and other conditions of the Central Vigilance Commissioner are similar to those of the Chairman of Union Public Service Commission.
- 3. The Lokpal can refer a complaint in respect of public servants belonging to Group A or Group B to the Central Vigilance Commission to conduct a preliminary inquiry.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only



- c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.13) Which of the following statements about the Central Vigilance Commission is incorrect?

- a) When there is no Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, then the Leader of the single largest group in the Opposition in the Lok Sabha can be a member of the appointment committee for members.
b) On ceasing to hold office, the Central Vigilance Commissioner is ineligible to be appointed as an administrator of a Union Territory.
c) The Central Vigilance Commissioner can be removed from the office by the President on the ground of 'proved misbehaviour or incapacity' after an inquiry by the Supreme Court.
d) None of the above

Q.14) Consider the following statements about Central Vigilance Commission:

1. The Commission has been provided powers of civil court.
2. The expenses of the Commission are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India
3. The central government has to consult the Commission in making any rules or regulations governing the disciplinary matters for the members of All India Services.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.15) Consider the following statements about Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir:

1. Legislative assembly in the UT of Jammu and Kashmir is provided under the Article 239A of the Constitution.
2. Lieutenant Governor of the UT of Jammu and Kashmir can nominate two women members to the legislative assembly.
3. Every member of the legislative assembly, before taking seat in the assembly shall make and subscribe an oath before the Lieutenant Governor.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.16) The prior recommendation of the President is needed to introduce which of these bills in the Parliament?

1. A bill involving expenditure from the Consolidated Fund of India.
2. A bill for the alteration of boundaries of states.
3. A private member bill that concerns minority welfare.
4. Any ordinary bill in which the states may be interested.

Select the correct Ans using the codes below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
b) 3 and 4 only
c) 1, 2 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Q.17) Article 123 of the Constitution empowers the President to promulgate ordinances. Consider the following in this regard.

1. An ordinance made when both the Houses are in session is valid if approved by the Council of Ministers and Parliament.
2. An ordinance cannot be used to amend the constitution.

Which of the above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) None of the above

Q.18) Which of the following compulsory provisions/features of 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act (1992)

1. Indirect elections of chairperson of panchayats at the intermediate and district levels.
2. Indirect elections to all seats in panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.
3. Providing reservation for the seats of other backward classes in panchayats at any level.

Select the correct Ans using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
b) 1 and 2 only
c) 2 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.19) Which of the following statements are correct with reference to the 74 th Constitutional Amendment.

1. It provides for the reservation of seats for the scheduled castes and the scheduled tribes in every



municipality in proportion to its population to the total population in the municipal area

2. It provides for the reservation of not less than one-third of the total number of seats for women excluding those reserved for SC/ST women.
3. It is obligatory on the state government to devolve powers to the municipalities so as to enable them to function as institutions of self-government

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.20) Which of the following statements about Union territories (UTs) is incorrect?

- a) The Constitution provides for President's rule under Article 356 in case of failure of Constitutional machinery in the National Capital Territory of Delhi.
- b) The administrator of an UT can promulgate legislation only during the recess of the legislative assembly.
- c) The President can make regulations for peace, progress and good government of the UT of Lakshadweep.
- d) Parliament can constitute a separate High Court for a UT.

Q.21) Consider the following statements about the Union Territory of Puducherry:

1. The President summons and prorogue the sessions of the Legislative Assembly.
2. The quorum of the meeting of the legislative assembly is one-third of the total number of members of the Assembly.
3. The central government can nominate maximum five persons as to be members of the legislative assembly.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.22) Consider the following statements regarding reservation under 74th Amendment act

1. The act provides for reservation of not less than one-third of total numbers of seats for women.
2. The act provides that $\frac{1}{3}$ rd of seats for the chairperson shall be reserved for women.

3. The reservation for SC/ST is determined as per their proportion of population in respective states.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.23) Consider the following statements:

1. Notified area committees are formed by notification in the government gazette.
2. Town area committee is formed by a separate act of state legislature.
3. Town area committee can be an entirely nominated body.
4. Members of the notified area committee are elected as well as nominated.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 1, 3 and 4 only
- c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Q.24) Consider the following statements:

1. 73rd Amendment Act of Indian Constitution does not apply to states of Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram.
2. The Panchayati Raj Act bars interference of Court in delimitation of Constituencies of Panchayats.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Neither 1 or 2
- d) Both 1 and 2

Q.25) The National Human Rights Commission is a multi-member body consisting of a chairman and four members. Consider the following about them:

1. The chairman should be a retired chief justice of India or a retired Chief Justice of the High courts.
2. Term of office for members is 5 years.
3. The chairman of the National Commission for Minorities is an ex-officio member of the NHRC.
4. The chairman of the National Commission for Women is an observer at the NHRC.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 3 only



d) None of the above

Q.26) With regard to the State Human Rights Commission, consider the following statement:

1. It has all the powers of the civil court.
2. It cannot look into a matter beyond one year of its occurrence.
3. Its recommendations regarding payment of compensation or damages to the victim are binding to the state government

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.27) Consider the following about the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) and State Human right commission (SHRC).

1. The chairperson and members of the NHRC and SHRC will hold office for five years or till the age of seventy years, whichever is earlier
2. The chairperson of a SHRC is a person who has been a Chief Justice of a High Court only.
3. The central government may confer on a SHRC human rights functions being discharged by Union Territories

Which of the above statement/s is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.28) Consider the following statements about State Human Rights Commission:

1. The State Human Rights Commission can inquire into violation of human rights only in respect of subjects mentioned in the State List and the Concurrent List.
2. The chairperson and members hold office for a term of three years or until age of 70 years
3. Salaries, allowances and other conditions of service of the chairperson or a member are determined by the governor of the state.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only

d) 1,2 and 3.

Q.29) Consider the following statements

1. The members of a State Human Rights Commission are appointed and removed by the Governor.
2. To remove members on ground of incapacity the Governor has to refer the matter to the High Court of State for enquiry.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.30) Consider the following statements about Lokpal and Lokayukta:

1. The setting up of Lokpal and Lokayukta was first recommended by second administrative Reforms Commission
2. Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013 seeks to provide uniform vigilance across the nation.
3. The structure and jurisdiction of Lokayukta is same in all states

Select the incorrect statement/s from the code given below

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1,2 and 3 only

Q.31) Who of the following are included in select committee to select members of Lokpal:

1. Prime minister
2. Union Minister of Home Affairs
3. Speaker of Lok Sabha
4. Leader of opposition in Lok Sabha
5. Chief Justice of India or sitting judge nominated by chief justice
6. Eminent jurist

Select the correct Ans from the code given below:

- a) 1,2,3,4 and 5 only
- b) 1,3,4 and 5 only
- c) 1,3,4,5 and 6
- d) All of the above

Q.32) Which of the following are covered under jurisdiction of Lokpal:

1. Prime Minister
2. Institutions aided by the government
3. Institutions partly financed by the government

Select the correct Ans from the code given below:



- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.33) Consider the following statements:

- 1. Clear timeline has been laid out for Lokpal to carry out preliminary enquiry as well as investigation.
- 2. There is no time limit to file complaint against public servants

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor

Q.34) Consider the following statements:

- 1. Entities receiving donations from foreign sources in excess of 10 lakhs per year are covered under the jurisdiction of Lokpal.
- 2. Lokpal can suo motu proceed investigation against any public servant.
- 3. Anonymous complaints are not allowed in Lokpal.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.35) Consider the following statements

- 1. Central Information commission consists of a Chief Information Commissioner and not more than ten Information Commissioners while State information commission consist of Chief Information Commissioner and not more than five Information Commissioners.
- 2. The members of Central information commission are appointed and removed by the President
- 3. The members of the state information commission are appointed by the governor but removed only by the President.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.36) Consider the following statements about State Information Commission:

- 1. State Chief Information Commissioner and a State Information Commissioner holds office for a term of Five years.
- 2. The salary, allowances and other service conditions of the State Chief Information Commissioner and a State Information Commissioner shall be such as prescribed by The Central Government
- 3. Deductions in salary of State Chief Information Commissioner and a State Information Commissioner can be done due to pension or any other retirement benefits received by them for their previous government service.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 2 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.37) Consider the following statements

- 1. The members of Central information commission are not eligible for Re-appointments
- 2. The Commission can order an inquiry into any matter in suo motu manner.
- 3. Central information commission Falls Under the ministry of home affairs.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) All of the above

Q.38) Consider the following statements with respect to the provisions under the Right to Information (RTI) in India and recent judicial pronouncements.

- 1. Information on expenditure of government money in an official capacity cannot be regarded as personal information under the RTI.
- 2. Larger public interest justifies the disclosure of personal information about a public authority.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.39) With reference to the Official Language of the States which of the following statements is/are incorrect?

- 1. Constitution did not specify the official language for different states



2. The President may direct a state, a language that shall be officially recognised in that state without any demand being made.
3. The legislature of a state is satisfied that a substantial proportion of the population desire the use of any language spoken by them to be recognised, then it may direct that such language shall also be officially recognised in that state.

Select the Ans using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.40) A resolution of disapproval of national emergency is different from a resolution approving the continuation of a proclamation in which of the following respects?

1. Disapproval of emergency requires the approval of both the houses, whereas approval of proclamation can be given only by the Lok Sabha.
2. Disapproval requires a special majority, whereas approval requires a simple majority.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.41) With reference to National emergency, consider the following statements:

1. The resolution disapproving the continuation of emergency must be passed by both the houses of the parliament.
2. The President may revoke a proclamation of emergency by a subsequent proclamation without any parliamentary approval.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.42) Consider the following statements regarding National Emergency:

1. The normal term of Lok Sabha can be extended by a law of parliament for one year at a time.
2. Article 358 extends to the whole country whereas Article 359 may extend to the whole country or a part of it.

3. Article 358 only applies if there is an internal Emergency and Article 359 applies only if there is an External Emergency.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 1,2 and 3
- d) None of the above

Q.43) With reference to Panchayati Raj in India, consider the following statements.

1. National Development Council envisaged uniformity with regard to the set up Panchayati Raj Institutions among the states in India after acceptance of Balwant Rai Mehta Committee report.
2. Andhra Pradesh was the first to adopt the system in India.
3. Panchayati Raj exists in all states of India, except Delhi and the Union Territories.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.44) Consider the following statements regarding the reservation of seats in the Panchayati Raj Institutions.

1. State legislature is authorized to make provisions for reservation of seats in favour of backward classes.
2. One-third of the total number of seats to be reserved for women in addition to the number of seats reserved for women belonging to the Scheduled castes and Scheduled tribes.
3. Some states in India have more than the prescribed reservation percentage for women in the panchayats.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.45) Consider the following statements with respect to elections of Panchayati Raj Institutions:

1. The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, bars the interference of the courts in the electoral matters of the Panchayats.



2. The superintendence, direction and control of preparation of electoral rolls shall be done by the State Election Commission.
3. All questions relating to disqualification of a candidate shall be decided by the State Election Commission.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.46) Which of the following subjects comes under the purview of the panchayats?

1. Land improvement, implementation of land reforms, land consolidation and soil conservation.
2. Small scale industries, including food processing industries.
3. Poverty alleviation programme.
4. Drinking water.
5. Health and sanitation including hospitals.
6. Social welfare, including welfare of the handicapped and mentally retarded.
7. Planning for economic and social development.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below.

- a) 1, 2, 3, 5 and 6 only
- b) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6 only
- c) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- d) All of the above

Q.47) With reference to the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992, consider the following statements:

1. Gram Sabha consists of persons registered as a voter anywhere in the state, and not particularly of a village within the area of a panchayat at a village level.
2. Mandatory provision of 3 tier system of Panchayati Raj in every state.
3. Chairpersons of panchayats at the intermediate and district levels shall be elected indirectly.

Which of the above statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.48) Identify the compulsory provisions of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act (1992).

1. Organization of Gram Sabha in a village or group of villages.

2. Establishment of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.
3. Provides reservation of seats (both members and chairpersons) for backward classes in panchayats at any level.
4. Granting financial powers to the panchayats.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) 4 only

Q.49) Which of the following is/are the features of the Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas Act, Act (1996)?

1. Every Gram Sabha has the right to preserve and continue with their traditional way of living including community resources.
2. All seats of Chairpersons of Panchayats at all levels shall be reserved for the Scheduled Tribes.
3. Recommendation of the Gram Sabha at the appropriate level is mandatory for granting mining licence for minor minerals in the Scheduled areas.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.50) With respect to the Urban Local Bodies in India, consider the following statements;

1. The first Municipal Corporation in India was set up at Calcutta.
2. The democratically elected urban local bodies were constitutionalized through the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992.
3. Construction and maintenance of rescue homes and orphanages are among the obligatory functions of it.

Which of the statements given above is/are Correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.51) With reference to the 74th Amendment Act of 1992, consider the following statements.

1. Three types of Municipalities to be set up in every state.
2. The State legislature can determine the manner of election of the chairperson of the municipality.



3. People with special knowledge can be nominated in the municipality.
4. One-third of the seats are reserved for the Scheduled castes and scheduled tribes in every municipality.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.52) With reference to the power, authority and responsibilities of the Municipalities, consider the following statement;

1. legislature of a state may empower municipality for Preparation of plans for economic development and social justice.
2. They have constitutional responsibilities in respect to matters enumerated in Schedule XII of the Constitution.
3. The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs releases the Municipal Performance Index to review the performance of the Municipalities in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.53) Which of the following functional items are placed under the purview of the municipalities under the Twelfth Schedule of the Constitution?

1. Regulation of land use.
2. Promotion of cultural, educational and aesthetic aspects.
3. Cattle ponds, prevention of cruelty to animals.
4. Regulation of slaughterhouses and tanneries.
5. Safeguarding the weaker sections of the society, including the handicapped and mentally retarded.
6. Adult and non-formal education.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below;

- a) 1, 2, 4 and 5 only
- b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.54) With reference to Urban Governments consider the following statements;

1. Port Trust also comes under the Urban Local bodies in India.

2. The council, standing committee and the Commissioner are authorities under the Municipal corporation.
3. The chairman of the Municipal Council enjoys executive powers.
4. A notified Area committee is an elected body.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.55) The State legislature may by law allow for the Municipality to which of the following?

1. To levy and collect taxes, duties and tolls.
2. Get grants-in-aid from the consolidated fund of the State.
3. To prepare plans for economic development and social justice.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 only
- d) All of the above

Q.56) With reference to Niti Aayog, consider the following statements;

1. It is created by an act of Parliament, and is a statutory body.
2. Platform for resolution of inter-sectoral and inter-departmental issues is one of the objectives of NITI Aayog.
3. Recently it released a report, 'Connected Commerce': Creating a road map for a digitally inclusive Bharat.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.57) With reference to the composition of Niti Aayog, the full-time organisational framework consists of which of the following?

1. Prime Minister.
2. Vice chairperson.
3. Chief Executive officer.
4. Union council of ministers (4 at maximum).
5. Lt. Governors of the Union Territories with legislatures.

Select the correct Ans from the codes given below.



- a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
- b) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
- d) All of the above

Q.58) Consider the following statements regarding the National Development Council.

1. It was established by an executive resolution by the Government of India, on the recommendation of the first Five Year Plan.
2. All union cabinet ministers are its members.
3. Promotion of common economic policies in all vital spheres is one of its major objectives.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct ?

- a) 1, 2 and 3
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.59) Consider the following statements regarding the National Human Rights Commission.

1. A serving Chief Justice of a High Court cannot be its member.
2. The committee that recommends the appointment of chairpersons and members consist of the leader of the opposition of the Lok Sabha only and not Rajya Sabha.
3. It can intervene in any proceeding involving allegations of violation of human rights pending before a court.
4. No dedicated investigating work force of its own, depended on central/state machinery.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.60) What are the measures that the National Human Rights Commission can take after the completion of an inquiry.

1. It can recommend to the concerned government for the grant of immediate interim relief to the victim.
2. It can recommend to the concerned government to make Compensation or damages to the victim.
3. It Can prosecute the guilty public servant.
4. Can pass necessary orders and directions related to the case in which inquiry is completed.

Which of the given statements above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) All of the above

Q.61) With reference to the Human Rights Courts, consider the following statements.

1. The courts are set up by the State Government with the concurrence of the Governor of the State.
2. For every Human Rights Court the Governor appoints a public prosecutor.

Which of the above statement/s is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.62) Which of the following statements is incorrect regarding the provisions of the Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019?

- a) A judge of the Supreme Court can now also be appointed as a chairperson of the NHRC.
- b) Appointment of members having knowledge or practical experience has been increased from two to three.
- c) There is no provision for reappointment of the Chairperson NHRC and SHRC.
- d) The Secretary General of NHRC can exercise administrative and financial powers.

Q.63) Which of the following changes were made to the composition of CBI by the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013).

1. Appointment of the Director of CBI to be made by the central government on the recommendation of a three-member committee headed by the Prime Minister.
2. Appointment of the Director of the Directorate of prosecution to be made by the central government on the recommendation of the Central Vigilance Commission.
3. Appointment of officers on the rank of SP and above in the CBI to be made by the Director of the CBI on the recommendation of the Central Vigilance Commission.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1, 2 and 3
- c) 3 only
- d) 1 and 2 only



Q.64) Which one of the following is not a function of the Central Bureau of Investigation?

- a) Maintaining crime statistics and disseminating criminal information.
- b) The CBI acts as the "National Central Bureau" of Interpol in India.
- c) To coordinate the activities of the various state police forces and anti-corruption agencies.
- d) Acts as an authority to receive information that is related to suspicious transactions under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002

Q.65) With reference to the Central Vigilance Commission, consider the following statement.

- 1. It was established on the recommendation of Santhanam Committee.
- 2. CVC works under the aegis of Union Home ministry and is an apex vigilance institution monitoring all vigilance activity under the Central Government.
- 3. It has a dedicated workforce within it, for conducting various investigations, and works as premier investigating agency to the Government of India.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.66) With reference to the Lokayuktas, consider the following statements.

- 1. The institution of Lokayuktas first time came into frame after the enactment of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013) in India.
- 2. While appointing the Lokayukta, the Governor of the state consults the Chief justice of the state High Court only.
- 3. There is no uniform criteria of qualification for appointment.
- 4. There is uniformity in jurisdiction of Lokayukta in all the states of India.
- 5. The office of Lokayukta can start suo motu proceedings across all states in India.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
- b) 2, 4, and 5 only
- c) 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.67) With respect to the removal of the State Chief Information Commissioner from office, consider the following statements.

- 1. Removed from his/her office by order of the Governor after an inquiry by the concerned state High Court.
- 2. Governor can remove State Chief Information Commissioner or State Information officer, if he/she has acquired any financial or other interests that will hamper the functioning of the same.
- 3. He/she can be suspended and debarred from attending office by the Governor during an inquiry of the Supreme Court against him/her.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.68) With respect to the Central Information Commission, consider the following statement,

- 1. It was constituted under the Right to Information Act 2005 and is a non- constitutional body.
- 2. The recommendation committee for the appointment of the commissioner of the CIC includes the Speaker of the Lok sabha.
- 3. The commission has the power to examine any record under the control of public authority.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.69) Consider the following statements regarding Part XXI of the Constitution of India.

- 1. Special provisions for 12 states are enlisted in this part of the Constitution.
- 2. They have been incorporated in the constitution when it came into force.
- 3. Under article 371 the President is authorised to provide that the Governor of Maharashtra and Governor Gujarat would have special responsibility.
- 4. Odisha and Bihar are amongst the enlisted states in Part XXI of the Constitution of India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above



Q.70) With reference to the administration of Union Territories, consider the following statements.

1. The Governor of a neighbouring state of a Union Territory can be an administrator of it.
2. In the case of Delhi, disagreement on any matter between the elected government and the Lieutenant Governor of the Union territory is decided by the President of India.
3. The constitution provides for an administrator for each Union territory equivalent to the head of the state like governor.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.71) With reference to the Banks Board Bureau, consider the following statements:

1. It was set up under the recommendations of the PJ Nayak Committee.
2. The Nationalised Banks (Management and Miscellaneous Provisions) Scheme, 1980 provides the legal framework for composition and functions of the Banks Board Bureau.

Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.72) With reference to Electoral bonds in India, consider the following statements:

1. A Company where the controlling stake is held by a foreign entity cannot purchase an Electoral Bond.
2. The electoral bonds scheme has removed all pre-existing limits on political donations.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.73) The "Faith For Rights Movement", recently seen in news, is an initiative under the aegis of

- a) United Nations Office of the High Commissioner of Human Rights
- b) The United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
- c) The United Nations Human Rights Council

- d) None of the Above

Q.74) The Ease of Living Index is published by

- a) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- b) Ministry of Finance
- c) Reserve Bank of India
- d) Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)

Q.75) With reference to the Land ports Authority (LPA) of India, consider the following statements:

1. Unlike the Island Development Agency, the LPA comes under the purview of the Ministry of Defence.
2. Unlike the Island Development Agency, the LPA is a statutory body.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.76) The Central Warehousing Corporation comes under the purview of

- a) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmer Welfare
- b) Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution
- c) Ministry of Power
- d) Ministry of Labour and Employment

Q.77) What are the possible advantages of aluminium air batteries (AAB) in the context of India's push for Electric Vehicles?

1. An AAB is considerably lighter than a comparable lithium-ion battery.
2. AABs are rechargeable and are more energy dense than lithium-ion batteries.
3. AABs are expected to offer a greater range of mobility per unit of full charge.

Select the correct Ans using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.78) The Contingent Reserve Arrangement, sometimes seen in news, is associated with

- a) G-20
- b) G-7
- c) BRICS
- d) SAARC



Q.79) The Phenomenon of “Quasi-resonant amplification (QRA)”, recently seen in news, is associated with

- a) Pulsars and Outer Space Activities
- b) Molten Core of the Earth
- c) Rossby waves and Jet streams
- d) None of the Above

Q.80) With reference to the World-Wide Fund for Nature (WWF), consider the following statements:

1. It was founded in the same year as the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).
2. It publishes the Living Planet Report on a biannual basis.
3. It aims to stop the degradation of the planet's natural environment and to build a future in which humans live in harmony with nature.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 2 only

Q.81) In the context of Art and Culture of India, what are *Kinnauri*, *Kashmiri Rouff*, and *Rathwa ni gher* types of?

- a) Temple Architecture
- b) Embroidery
- c) Dance Forms
- d) Paintings

Q.82) With reference to The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA), consider the following statements:

1. It is a statutory body under the purview of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
2. It is mandated with the responsibility of export promotion of both alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages.
3. It has also been entrusted with the responsibility to monitor import of sugar.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.83) Which of the following cities lies closest to the latitude passing through Chabahal?

- a) Patna
- b) Ahmedabad
- c) New Delhi
- d) Nagpur

Q.84) With reference to the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, consider the following statements:

1. The initiative was officially launched by India at the The UN Climate Change Conference (COP) 25 in Madrid
2. It aims to promote the resilience of existing infrastructure systems only.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.85) An initiative known as “Marine Spatial Planning” for sustainable ocean resources utilisation to advance economic and social development in coastal areas is a joint endeavour between India and

- a) Norway
- b) Sweden
- c) Belarus
- d) Denmark

Q.86) Recently, there was a growing awareness in our country about the importance of improved variety of wild marigold (*Tagetes minuta*) because it is found to be beneficial for

- a) Anti-Cancer Drug
- b) Perfumes and essences
- c) Technical Textiles
- d) Sericulture

Q.87) Consider the following statements:

1. Mission SHAKTI is the self-help mission for protecting and empowering women through promotion of Women Self Help Groups (WSHGs) to take up various socio-economic activities.
2. Mission VATSALYA is a scheme for looking into child protection services and child welfare services.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above



Q.88) Which of the following phrases best describes the terms “Kolami, Vadi, and Dhatt” seen recently in the news ?

- a) Endangered tribal languages
- b) Local varieties of Paddy
- c) Names of Hillocks in the Eastern Ghats
- d) Regional Dance forms

Q.89) What are the possible benefits of the NISAR mission, the joint Earth-observing mission between NASA and the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)?

- 1. Better understanding of the effects and pace of climate change.
- 2. Wholesome understanding of Earth’s crust and tectonic Movements
- 3. Spotting warning signs of imminent volcanic eruptions
- 4. Monitoring of surface soil moisture
- 5. Rapid Damage Assessment after Natural Disaster

Select the correct Ans using the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 3 only
- b) 1,4 and 5 only
- c) 2,3 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,3,4 and 5

Q.90) Consider the following:

- 1. Jawadi hills
- 2. Shevaroy Hills
- 3. Nagari Hills
- 4. Cardamom Hills

The correct sequence of the above geographical features from north to South is:

- a) 3-2-1-4
- b) 3-4-1-2
- c) 3-1-2-4
- d) 4-2-3-1

Q.91) Consider the following statements:

- 1. India’s Self-sufficiency in Petroleum Products, measured on a consumption basis, has consistently increased in the last 5 years.
- 2. The Quantity of Liquified Natural Gas imported by India has consistently decreased in the last 5 years.
- 3. The Quantity of Crude oil imported by India has consistently decreased in the last 5 years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1,2 and 3
- d) None of the above

Q.92) The Core-Accretion Model and the Competitive Accretion Model, sometimes seen in the media, are associated with the formation of

- a) Antibodies in response to microbial infection
- b) Tropical Cyclones and Hurricanes
- c) Massive Stars
- d) Landforms of Earth

Q.93) Consider the following statements:

- 1. According to the constitution of India, Every Judge of a High Court is appointed by the President after consultation with only the Chief Justice of India and the Governor of the State.
- 2. According to the constitution of India, any question of age of a Judge of a High Court is to be decided by the President after consultation with the Chief Justice of the respective High Court.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.94) With reference to Shadow entrepreneurship, consider the following statements:

- 1. Shadow entrepreneurship are the businesses that trade in legitimate goods and services but are not enrolled with the government.
- 2. The unlicensed taxicab services and e-pharmacies are examples of shadow entrepreneurship.
- 3. India and the USA have the highest number of shadow entrepreneurs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.95) Consider the following statements regarding Akash Missile:

- 1. It is India’s first indigenously produced short-range air to the Surface missile.
- 2. It is developed as a part of the integrated guided-missile development programme.
- 3. It is a supersonic nuclear-capable missile.

Select the correct Ans using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only



- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.96) Consider the following statements.

1. Antibodies attach to the surface structures of bacteria or viruses and obstruct their replication.
2. Nanobodies are antibody fragments that can be fabricated by bacteria or yeast.
3. Manufacturing Nanobodies is difficult and time-consuming and therefore not appropriate for widespread use.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.97) Consider the following statements with reference to Asian Waterbird Census:

1. It is an integral part of the global waterbird monitoring programme.
2. The census covers West Asia, Neotropics and Caribbean Flyway.
3. It is jointly coordinated by the Bombay Natural History Society and Wetlands International, in India.

Select the correct Ans using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.98) With which of the following organisations/movements was the Lala Lajpat Rai associated?

1. Hindu Relief Movement
2. Servants of People Society
3. All India Trade Union Congress
4. Hindu Mahasabha

Select the correct Ans using the code given below:

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.99) With reference to Indian Pangolin, consider the following statements:

1. It is endemic to the high Himalayas and the arid region in India.
2. Its IUCN status is critically endangered and placed in Schedule I of Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.100) With reference to Monetary Policy, consider the following statements:

1. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is vested with the responsibility of conducting monetary policy under the provisions of the Agreement on Monetary Policy Framework Act.
2. The main objective of monetary policy is to sustain price stability and achieve growth.
3. The inflation target is set by the Reserve Bank of India in consultation with the Government of India, once every five years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only



Q.1) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** A sitting judge of the Supreme Court (or a sitting chief justice of a High Court) can be appointed as a member of the National Human Rights Commission, but that can be done only after consultation with the Chief Justice of India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The chairperson and members are appointed by the president on the recommendations of a six-member committee consisting of the prime minister as its head, the Speaker of the Lok Sabha, the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha, leaders of the Opposition in both the Houses of Parliament and the Central home minister.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The chairman and members hold office for a term of three years or until they attain the age of 70 years.

Reference: Laxmikanth

Q.2) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Commission cannot inquire into any matter after the expiry of one year from the date on which the act constituting violation of human rights is alleged to have been committed.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Chairman or any member of the Commission can be removed by the President on the ground of 'proved misbehaviour and incapacity' after an inquiry by the Supreme Court. The President can remove the chairman or any member under following circumstances as well:
 - (a) If he is adjudged an insolvent; or
 - (b) If he engages, during his term of office, in any paid employment outside the duties of his office; or
 - (c) If he is unfit to continue in office by reason of infirmity of mind or body; or
 - (d) If he is of unsound mind and stand so declared by a competent court; or
 - (e) If he is convicted and sentenced to imprisonment for an offence.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 empowers the Commission to inquire into any violation of human rights, either suo motu or on a petition presented to it.

Reference: The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Q.3) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect and Statement 2 is correct:** The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provided for four other members of the Commission: one serving or retired judge of the Supreme Court; one serving or retired Chief Justice of High Court; and two persons having knowledge or practical experience with respect to human rights. The Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019 increased the number of persons having knowledge or practice experience with respect to human rights to three (total five other members), out of which at least one should be a woman.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019 included Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities as an ex-officio member of the Commission.

Reference:

The Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019

Q.4) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that the Commission can intervene in any proceeding involving any allegation of violation of human rights pending before a court with the approval of such court.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that the Commission may recommend the government or authority to make payment of compensation to the victim of human rights violation.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that in case of allegation of violation of human rights by the armed forces the Central Government shall inform the Commission of the action taken on the recommendations within three months.

Reference:

The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993



Q.5) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that the Chairperson or a member of the Commission, on ceasing to hold office, is ineligible for further employment under the Government of a State or under the Government of India.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Chairperson or a member of the Commission can be removed by the President (not the Governor of the State) on the same ground as the chairperson or members of the National Human Rights Commission.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that a State Human Rights Commission can inquire into violation of human rights in respect of subjects mentioned in the State List and Concurrent List of the Seventh schedule of the Constitution.

Reference: The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Q.6) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that the chairperson or a member of a state human rights commission may, by notice in writing under his hand addressed to the Governor, resign from the office.
- **Option B is correct:** The Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted that the central government may by order, confer upon the State Human Rights Commission the functions relating to human rights being discharged by the Union territories. The functions relating to human rights in case of UT of Delhi shall be dealt with by the National Human Rights Commission.
- **Option C is correct:** Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 provides that two or more states with the consent of a chairperson or member of a state human rights commission may appoint such chairperson or such member of another state human rights commission simultaneously if such chairperson or member consents to such appointment.

Reference:

The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Q.7) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that a person of less than 45 years of age, on the date of assuming office as the chairperson or member cannot become the chairperson or member of the Lokpal.
- **Option B is incorrect:** The selection committee for the appointment of Chairperson and members of the Lokpal consists of: i) Prime Minister as chairperson; ii) Speaker of Lok Sabha as member; iii) Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha as member; iv) Chief Justice of India or a Judge of Supreme Court nominated by him as member; v) One eminent jurist, to be nominated by the President of India on the basis of recommendations of the first four members of the selection committee.
- **Option C is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the appointment of a new chairperson or member should be done at least three months before the expiry of the term of the chairperson or member.
- **Option D is correct:** The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the salary, allowance and other conditions of service of chairperson should be same as those of Chief Justice of India and that of other members should be same as those of a Judge of the Supreme Court.

Reference:

The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

Q.8) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Section 8 of the Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013 provides that after ceasing to hold office, the Chairperson is ineligible for any diplomatic assignment, appointment as an administrator of a Union Territory and such other assignment or appointment which is required by law to be made by the President by warrant under his hand and seal.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Lokpal consists of a chairperson and maximum eight members, out of which 50% are Judicial members. Also, not less than 50% of the members of the Lokpal are from amongst the persons belonging to the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, Minorities and Women.



- **Statement 3 is correct:** Section 4 of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the Selection Committee for the purposes of selecting the chairperson and members of the Lokpal and for preparing a panel of persons to be considered for appointment, constitutes a Search Committee, consisting of at least seven persons of standing and having special knowledge and expertise in the matters relating to anti-corruption policy, public administration, vigilance, policy making, finance including insurance and banking, law and management or in any other matter which, in the opinion of the Selection Committee, may be useful in making the selection of the Chairperson and Members of the Lokpal.

Reference: The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

Q.9) Ans: A

Exp:

Section 14(a) of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides the provisions for inquiry into allegation of corruption against Prime Minister and makes following provisions

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Lokpal cannot inquire about any matter related with international relations, external and internal security, public order, atomic energy and space.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The inquiry cannot be held unless a full bench of the Lokpal consisting of its Chairperson and all members considers the initiation of inquiry and at least two-third of the members approves such inquiry.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Any inquiry against the Prime Minister shall be held in camera and if Lokpal comes to the conclusion that the complaint deserves to be dismissed, the records of the inquiry shall not be published or made available to anyone.

Reference: The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

Q.10) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that only a special court constituted under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 can take cognizance of false and frivolous or vexatious complaint under the Act.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that The Lokpal shall function as the final appellate authority in respect of appeals arising out of any other law for the time being in force providing for delivery of public services and redressal of public grievances by any public authority in cases where the decision contains findings of corruption under the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the Lokpal shall not inquire or investigate into any complaint, if the complaint is made after the expiry of a period of seven years from the date on which the offence mentioned in such complaint is alleged to have been committed.

Reference: The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

Q.11) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the Lokpal cannot inquire into any complaint made against the Chairperson or any member of Lokpal.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the Chairperson and every member is ineligible for contesting any election of President or Vice-President or Member of either House of Parliament or Member of either House of a State Legislature or Municipality or Panchayat within a period of five years from the date of relinquishing the post.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 provides that the Chairperson or any member can be removed from his office by order of the President on grounds of **misbehaviour** after the Supreme Court, on a reference being made to it by the President on a petition signed by at least one hundred Members of Parliament has, on an inquiry held in accordance with the procedure, reported that the Chairperson or such Member, as the case may be, ought to be removed on such ground.

Reference: The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

Q.12) Ans: D

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Chairperson and members of Central Vigilance Commission are appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal on the recommendation of a three-member committee consisting of the Prime Minister as its head, the Union Minister of Home Affairs and the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The salary, allowances and other conditions of the Central Vigilance Commissioner are similar to those of the Chairman of Union Public Service Commission.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Under the section 20 of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013, the Lokpal can refer a complaint in respect of public servants belonging to Group A or Group B or Group C or Group D to the Central Vigilance Commission to conduct preliminary inquiry.

Reference: Laxmikanth

Q.13) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that for the purpose of appointment committee for the Chief Vigilance Commissioner and Vigilance Commissioner, the "Leader of the Opposition in the House of the People" shall, when no such Leader has been so recognised, include the Leader of the single largest group in opposition of the Government in the House of the People.
- **Option B is correct:** Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that on ceasing to hold office, the Central Vigilance Commissioner and every other Vigilance Commissioner shall be ineligible for any diplomatic assignment, appointment as administrator of a Union territory and such other assignment or appointment which is required by law to be made by the President by warrant under his hand and seal.
- **Option C is correct:** Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that the Central Vigilance Commissioner or any other Vigilance Commissioner can be removed from office by order of the President on the ground of proved misbehaviour or incapacity after the Supreme Court, on a reference made to it by the President, on inquiry, reports that the Central Vigilance

Commissioner or any Vigilance Commissioner ought on such ground be removed.

Reference: The Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003

Q.14) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that the Commission, while conducting any inquiry, has all powers of a civil court trying a suit under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Section 13 of the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that the expenses of the Commission, including any salaries, allowances and pensions payable to or in respect of the Central Vigilance Commissioner, the Vigilance Commissioners, Secretary and the staff of the Commission, shall be charged on the Consolidated Fund of India
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003 provides that the Central Government shall, in making any rules or regulations governing the vigilance or disciplinary matters relating to persons appointed to public services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union or to members of the All-India Services, consult the Commission.

Reference: The Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003

Q.15) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Section 13 of the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 provides that the provisions contained in Article 239A of the Constitution, which are applicable to UT of Puducherry are also applicable to UT of Jammu and Kashmir.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Section 15 of the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 provides that Lieutenant Governor can nominate two women members to the legislative assembly to give representation to women, if in his opinion, women are not adequately represented in the Legislative assembly.



- **Statement 3 is correct:** Section 24 of the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 provides that Every member of the legislative assembly, before taking seat in the assembly shall make and subscribe an oath before the Lieutenant Governor or some person appointed in that behalf by him.

Q.16) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: It becomes a money bill and thus the President must approve the introduction of the bill.

Statement 2 is correct: Under Article 3, the President must recommend the introduction of this bill as it has the potential to significantly affect the federal balance of power between centre and states.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The constitution does not distinguish between Private or public bills when it comes to the requirement of prior Presidential assent.

Statement 4 incorrect: It is only in certain cases, such as alternation of state boundaries which needs prior permission of the President. In other cases it is not mandatory.

Q.17) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: He can promulgate an ordinance only when both the Houses of Parliament are not in session .An ordinance can also be issued when only one House is in session because a law can be passed by both the Houses and not by one House alone.

An ordinance made when both the Houses are in session is void. Thus, the power of the President to legislate by ordinance is **not a parallel power of legislation**.

Statement 2 is correct: This is because a constitutional amendment requires a special majority in both houses of Parliament, unlike an ordinary legislation that can be approved by a simple majority. Moreover, some amendments may require the approval of half of the states as well with a special majority of parliament. Hence, 2 is correct

Q.18) Ans: A

Exp:

Statements 1 is correct and statement 2 is incorrect:

Compulsory Provisions

1. Organisation of Gram Sabha in a village or group of villages.
2. Establishing panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.
3. Direct elections to all seats in panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.
4. **Indirect elections to the post of chairperson of panchayats at the intermediate and district levels.**
5. Reservation of seats (both members and chairpersons) for SCs and STs in panchayats at all the three levels.
6. Reservation of one-third seats (both members and chairpersons) for women in panchayats at all the three level

Statement 3 is incorrect: Providing reservation of seats (both members and chairpersons) for backward classes in panchayats at any level is a voluntary provision.

Reference: Laxmikant

Q.19) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: It provides the reservation of seats for the scheduled castes and the scheduled tribes in every municipality in proportion of their population to the total population in the municipal area

Statement 2 is incorrect: it provides for the reservation of not less than one-third of the total number of seats for women (including the number of seats reserved for woman belonging to the SCs and the STs)

Statement 3 is incorrect: It is not obligatory and they are placed under voluntary provisions for the states.

Reference: Chapter Panchayati Raj Institutions, Laxmikanth

Q.20) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement A is incorrect:** Article 239AB of the Constitution provides that if the President, on



receipt of a report from the Lieutenant Governor or otherwise, is satisfied that a situation has arisen in which the administration of the National Capital Territory cannot be carried on in accordance with the provisions of article 239AA, then the President may by order suspend the operation of any provision of Article 239AA. Thus, this President's rule is different from that under Article 356.

- **Statement B is correct:** Article 239B provides that the administrator of an UT can promulgate legislation only during the recess of the legislative assembly. The administrator shall not promulgate any Ordinance during the period of such dissolution or suspension of legislature.
- **Statement C is correct:** The President can make regulations for peace, progress and good government of the UT of Andaman and Nicobar, Lakshadweep, Dadar and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu under Article 240 of the Constitution.
- **Statement D is correct:** Article 241 provides that the Parliament may by law constitute a High Court for a Union territory or declare any court in any such territory to be a High Court for all or any of the purposes of this Constitution.

Reference: The Constitution of India

Q.21) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Government of Union Territories Act, 1963 provides that the administrator summons, prorogue and dissolve the Assembly.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** the Government of Union Territories Act, 1963 provides that the quorum of the meeting of the legislative assembly is one-third of total number of members of the assembly.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Government of Union Territories Act, 1963 provides that the Central Government may nominate not more than three persons, not being persons in the service of Government, to be members of the Legislative Assembly.

Reference: The Government of Union Territories Act, 1963

Q.22) Ans: C

Exp:

Reservation of seats under 74th amendment Act:

- **SC and ST:** Reservation to be provided at all the three tiers in accordance with their **population percentage**.
- **Women:** Not less than **one-third** of the total number of seats to be reserved for women. Further the office of **chairperson** shall be reserved as per the provision of **state legislature**.
- **Others:** The **state legislatures** are also given the provision to decide on the reservation of seats in any level of panchayat or office of chairperson in favour of backward classes.

Statement 1 is correct: The act provides for reservation of not less than one-third of total numbers of seats for women.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The act provides that seats for the chairperson shall be reserved for women in accordance with state law.

Statement 3 is correct: The reservation for SC/ST is determined as per their proportion of population in respective states.

Source: Laxmikanth

Q.23) Ans: A

Exp:

Notified area Committee:

It is established by **gazette notification**. Though it functions within the framework of state municipal act only those provisions of act apply to it which are notified in government gazette. It is an **entirely nominated body** and all members including chairman are nominated by the state government.

Town area committee:

It is created by a **separate act of state legislature**. It may be **wholly elected or wholly nominated** by the state government **or partly elected and partly nominated**.

Statement 1 is correct: Notified area committees are formed by notification in the official gazette.

Statement 2 is correct: Town area committees are formed by a separate act of state legislature.



Statement 3 is correct: Town area committee can be an entirely nominated body.

Statement 4 is incorrect: Members of the notified area committee are **entirely nominated**.

Q.24) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect

The act does not apply to the states of Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram and certain other areas. These areas include

- (a) the scheduled areas and the tribal areas in the States
- (b) the hill area of Manipur for which a district council exists
- (c) Darjeeling district of West Bengal for which Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists.

Statement 2 is correct

The act bars the interference by courts in the electoral matters of panchayats. It declares that the validity of any law relating to the delimitation of constituencies or the allotment of seats to such constituencies cannot be questioned in any court.

Source: Laxmikanth

Q.25) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: Chairman should be a person who has been Chief Justice of the Supreme Court, or a Judge of the Supreme Court will be the chairperson of the NHRC (Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019)

Statement 2 is incorrect: It NHRC (Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019) reduces the term of office to three years or till the age of seventy years, whichever is earlier

Statement 3 is correct and Statement 4 is incorrect: :

The commission also has ex officio members—the chairman of the National Commission for Minorities, The National Commission for SCs, the

National Commission for STs, National Commission for Women, National commission for protection of child rights, National commission for backward class, Chief commissioner for person with disabilities.

Reference: <https://nhrc.nic.in/>

Q.26) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The Commission is vested with the power to regulate its own procedure. It has all the powers of a civil court and its proceedings have a judicial character.

Statement 2 is correct : The Commission can not inquire into any matter after the expiry of one year from the date on which the act constituting violation of human rights is alleged to have been committed. In other words, it can look into a matter within one year of its occurrence.

Statement 3 is incorrect: It may recommend to the state government or authority to make payment of compensation or damages to the victim But they are not binding.

Q.27) Ans: B

Exp:

Recently, the Parliament passed the Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019 to bring transparency of the selection process for the Chairperson and Members of the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Statement 1 is incorrect: It reduces the term of office to three years or till the age of seventy years, whichever is earlier. It removes the five-year limit for reappointment.

Statement 2 is incorrect: It amends this to provide that a person who has been Chief Justice or Judge of a High Court will be chairperson of a SHRC.

Statement 3 is correct: It provides that the central government may confer on a SHRC human rights



function being discharged by Union Territories. Functions relating to human rights in the case of Delhi will be dealt with by the NHRC

Q.28) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** State Human Rights Commission can **inquire into** violation of human rights only in respect of subjects mentioned in the **State List and the Concurrent List** of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution. However, if any such case is already being inquired into by the National Human Rights Commission or any other Statutory Commission, then the State Human Rights Commission does not inquire into that case
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The chairperson and members hold office for a **term of three years** or until they attain the age of 70 years, whichever is earlier. They are **eligible for reappointment**. After their tenure, the chairperson and members are **not eligible for further employment** under a state government or the Central government.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **salaries, allowances and other conditions** of service of the chairperson or a member are determined by the **state government** and not the governor of state.

Q.29) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The chairperson and members of a State Human Rights Commission are **appointed by the governor**, they **can be removed only by the President** (and not by the governor).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** In addition to these, the president can also remove the chairperson or a member on the ground of **proved misbehaviour or incapacity**. However, in these cases, the President has to **refer the matter to the Supreme Court** for an inquiry. If the Supreme Court, after the inquiry, upholds the cause of removal and advises so, then the President can remove the chairperson or a member.

Q.30) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC) of India (1966–1970) recommended the setting up of two special authorities designated as 'Lokpal' and 'Lokayukta' for the redressal of citizens' grievances. Thus it was first administrative Commission that first recommended setting up of Lokpal and Lokayukta.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013) seeks to establish the institution of the Lokpal at the Centre and the Lokayukta at the level of the State and thus seeks to **provide a uniform vigilance and anti-corruption** road map for the nation both at the Centre and at the States.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **structure of the lokayukta is not the same** in all the states. Some States like Rajasthan, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra have created the lokayukta as well as upalo-kayukta, while some others like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Himachal Pradesh have created only the lokayukta. There is **no uniformity regarding the jurisdiction** of lokayukta in all the states. For instance, The chief minister is included within the jurisdiction of lokayukta in the states of Himachal Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat, while he is excluded from the purview of loka-yukta in the states of Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar and Orissa.

Q.31) Ans: C

Exp:

Selection Committee consisting of the Prime Minister, the Speaker of the Lok Sabha, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, the Chief Justice of India or a sitting Supreme Court Judge nominated by the Chief Justice of India and an eminent jurist to be nominated by the President of India on the basis of recommendations of the first four members of the selection committee.

- **Option 1 is correct:** The Prime minister of is a member of selection committee
- **Option 2 is incorrect:** The Minister of Home Affairs is not a member of committee
- **Option 3 is correct:** Speaker of Lok Sabha is included in the committee
- **Option 4 is correct:** Leader of opposition in Lok Sabha is also in committee
- **Option 5 is correct:** The committee consists of Chief Justice of India or its Nominee



- **Option 6 is correct:** An eminent jurist is also part of committee

Q.32) Ans: c

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** The Prime Minister has been brought under the purview of the Lokpal with subject matter exclusions and specific process for handling complaints against the Prime Minister.
- **Option 2 is incorrect:** Institution aided by the government are not included under the jurisdiction of Lokpal
- **Option 3 is correct:** Institutions completely or partly financed by the government are included under the jurisdiction of Lokpal

Q.33) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013 lays down clear timelines. For preliminary enquiry, it is three months extendable by three months. For investigation, it is six months which may be extended by six months at a time. For trial, it is one year extendable by one year and to achieve this, special courts to be set up.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** There is a limitation period of 7 years provided in the Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013 to file complaints against erring officials and employees.

Q.34) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** All entities receiving donations from foreign sources in the context of the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA) in excess of ₹10 lakhs per year are brought under the jurisdiction of Lokpal.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Lokpal cannot suo motu proceed against any public servant. Lokpal takes cognisance of matters only when a petition is filed by anyone.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Anonymous complaints not allowed -Can't just make a complaint on plain paper and drop it in a box with supporting documents.

Q.35) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Central Information Commission (CIC) consists of a Chief Information Commissioner and not more than ten Information Commissioners. State Information Commission also consists of a State Chief Information Commissioner and not more than Ten State Information Commissioners. Thus both have similar permissible strength.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Members of the Central Information Commission are appointed by the President on the recommendation of a committee consisting of the Prime Minister as Chairperson, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. The President is also empowered to remove the Chief Information Commissioner or any Information Commissioner from the office
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Members of the State Information Commission are appointed by the Governor. The Governor can also remove the State Chief Information Commissioner or any State Information Commissioner.

Q.36) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Right to Information Act was amended in 2019. One of the amendments provided that the Chief Information Commissioner and an Information Commissioner shall hold office for such terms as prescribed by the Central Government. Before this amendment, their term was fixed for 5 years.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It provided that the salary, allowances and other service conditions of the State Chief Information Commissioner and a State Information Commissioner shall be such as prescribed by the Central Government. Before this

amendment, the salary, allowances and other service conditions of the State Chief Information Commissioner were similar to those of an Election Commissioner and that of a State Information Commissioner were similar to those of the Chief Secretary of the state government.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Right to Information Act was amended in 2019. It removed the provisions regarding deductions in salary of the Chief Information Commissioner, an Information Commissioner, the State Chief Information Commissioner and a State Information Commissioner due to pension or any other retirement benefits received by them for their previous government service.

Q.37) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Chief Information Commissioner and an Information Commissioner shall hold office for such terms as prescribed by the Central Government or until they attain the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. They are not eligible for reappointment.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Central Information Commission has the power to order inquiry into any matter if there are reasonable grounds in suo-moto power
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Central information commission does not fall under the ministry of Home Affairs. It comes under the Ministry of Personnel.

Q.38) Ans: C

Exp:

After a decade, the Supreme Court has accepted the Delhi High Court ruling that the office of the Chief Justice of India is a 'public authority', and hence would be subject to the same rules of transparency and accountability as other individuals and organisations in public life. The Supreme Court ruled that the office of

the Chief Justice of India (CJI) is a public authority under the Right to Information (RTI) Act.

Statement 1 is correct: Information on expenditure of government money in an official capacity cannot be regarded as personal information under the RTI.

Statement 2 is correct: Larger public interest justifies the disclosure of personal information about a public authority.

Q.39) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: - The Constitution did not specify the official language of different states, but made many provisions regarding it.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The legislature of a state may adopt any one or more of the languages in use in the state or Hindi as the official language of that state.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The President (on a demand being made) is satisfied that a substantial proportion of the population of a state desires the use of any language spoken by them to be recognised by that state, then he may direct that such language shall also be officially recognised in that state. This provision aims at protecting the linguistic interests of minorities in the states.

Source: M.LaxmiKanth

Q.40) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: disapproval is required to be passed by the Lok Sabha only, while the approval needs to be passed by both Houses of Parliament.

Statement 2 is incorrect: disapproval is to be adopted by a simple majority only, while the approval needs to be adopted by a special majority. This is done to put greater safeguards as emergency in an extraordinary measure and must be resorted to only in exceptional circumstances.

Q.41) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: There is no need for both houses to pass the resolution. The President must revoke national emergency if the Lok Sabha passes a resolution disapproving its continuation.



Statement 2 is correct: A proclamation of emergency may be revoked by the President at any time by a subsequent proclamation, without needing any parliamentary approval

Q.42) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: While National Emergency declaration is in force, the life of the Lok Sabha may be extended beyond its normal term (five years) by a law of Parliament for one year at a time (for any length of time). However, this extension cannot continue beyond a period of six months after the emergency is over.

Statement 2 is correct: Article 358 extends to the whole country whereas Article 359 may extend to the whole country or a part of it.

Articles 358 and 359 describe the impact of a National Emergency on the Fundamental Rights. **Article 358** deals with the suspension of the Fundamental Rights guaranteed by **Article 19**, while **Article 359** deals with the suspension of **other Fundamental Rights (other than those guaranteed by Articles 20 and 21)**

Statement 3 is incorrect: Article 358 only applies if there is an External Emergency (that is, when the emergency is declared on the grounds of war or external aggression) and not in an Internal Emergency (i.e., when the Emergency is declared due to armed rebellion). Article 359, on the other hand, applies in case of both External Emergency as well as Internal Emergency.

Reference: Chapter Emergency Provisions, Laxmikanth

Q.43) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The recommendation of the Balwant Rai Mehta committee for the development of Panchayati Raj Institutions was accepted by the National Development Council in January 1958. The council did not insist on a single rigid pattern and left it to the states to evolve their own pattern suitable to the local conditions, but the basic principles and broad fundamentals should be identical throughout the country. The differences from one state to another

with regard to the number of tiers, relative position of samitis and parishad, their tenure, composition, function, finances and so on. For example, Rajasthan adopted the three tier system, while Tamil Nadu adopted 2 tier system, whereas West Bengal adopted 4 tier system.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Rajasthan was the first state to establish Panchayati Raj in the country. It was inaugurated by the then Prime Minister in Nagaur District. Andhra Pradesh was the second state to follow.

Statement 3 is incorrect: It does not apply to the states of Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram and certain other area which includes (a) the scheduled areas and tribal areas in the states: (b) the hill area of Manipur for which a district council exists: and (c) Darjeeling district of West Bengal for which Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists. Regarding the Union Territories, the President of India may direct that the provisions of this act shall apply to any union territory subject to such exceptions and modifications as he may specify.

Q.44) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: There are provisions for reservation of seats for scheduled castes and scheduled tribes in every panchayat (at all three levels) in proportion of their population to the total population in the panchayat area. **The legislature of the state is also authorized to make any provision for reservation of seats in any panchayat or offices of chairperson in the panchayat at any level in favour of backward classes.**

Statement 2 is incorrect: Provisions for the reservation of not less than one-third of the total number of seats for women (**including the number of seats reserved for women belonging to the SCs and STs**). Further, not less than one-third of the total number of offices of chairpersons in the panchayats at each level shall be reserved for women.

Statement 3 is correct: States like Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Bihar have increased the reservation to 50% for women in the panchayats



Q.45) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The act bars the interference by courts in the electoral matters of panchayats. It declares that the validity of any law relating to the delimitation of constituencies or the allotment of seats to such constituencies cannot be questioned in any court. It further lays down that no election to any panchayat is to be questioned except by an election petition presented to such authority and in such manner as provided by the state legislature.

Statement 2 is correct: The matters related to the free and fair conduct of all elections shall be vested on the State Election Commission. It consists of a state election commissioner to be appointed by the Governor. The functions of the State Election Commission in this matter includes super-intendence, direction and control of the preparation of electoral rolls and the conduct of all elections to the panchayats.

Statement 3 is incorrect: A person shall be disqualified for being chosen as or for being a member of panchayat if he is so disqualified, (a) under any law for the time being in force for the purpose of elections to the state legislature of the state concerned, or (b) under any law made by the state legislature. However, no person shall be disqualified on the ground that he is less than 25 years of age if he has attained age of 21 years. Further, **all questions of disqualification shall be referred to such authority as the state legislature determines.**

Q.46) Ans: B

Exp:

The 11th Schedule of the Indian Constitution was added in 1992 by the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act. This schedule contains 29 subjects and covers important topics such as Panchayat's powers. Following are the functional subjects placed within the purview of the Panchayats:

1. Agriculture, including agricultural extension.
2. **Land improvement, implementation of land reforms, land consolidation and soil conservation.**
3. Minor irrigation, water management and watershed development.

4. Animal husbandry, dairying and poultry.

5. Fisheries.

6. Social forestry and farm forestry.

7. Minor forest produce.

8. **Small-scale industries, including food processing industries.**

9. KVC industries.

10. Rural housing.

11. **Drinking water.**

12. Fuel and fodder.

13. Roads, culverts, bridges, ferries, waterways and other means of communication.

14. Rural electrification, including distribution of electricity.

15. Non-conventional energy sources.

16. **Poverty alleviation programme.**

17. Education, including primary and secondary schools.

18. Technical training and vocational education.

19. Adult and non-formal education.

20. Libraries.

21. Cultural activities.

22. Markets and fairs.

23. **Health and sanitation including hospitals, primary health centres and dispensaries.**

24. Family welfare.

25. Women and child development.

26. Social welfare, including welfare of the handicapped and mentally retarded.

27. Welfare of the weaker sections, and in particular, of the scheduled castes and the scheduled tribes.

28. Public distribution system.

29. Maintenance of community assets.

Q.47) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Act provides for a Gram Sabha as the foundation of the panchayati raj system. It is a body consisting of persons registered in the electoral rolls of a village within the area of Panchayat at the village level. Thus, it is a village assembly consisting of all the registered voters in the area of the panchayat. It may exercise such powers and perform such functions at the village level as the legislature of a state determines.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Act provides for a three tier system of panchayati raj in every state, that is panchayats at the village, intermediate and district



levels. Thus the act brings about uniformity in the structure of panchayati raj throughout the country.

However, a state having a population not exceeding 20 lakh may not constitute panchayats at the intermediate level.

Statement 3 is correct: All the members of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels shall be elected directly by the people. **Further, the chairperson of panchayats at the intermediate and district levels shall be elected indirectly- by and from amongst the elected members there of.** However, the chairperson of a panchayat at the village level shall be elected in such manner as the state legislature determines.

Q.48) Ans: A

Exp:

Compulsory provisions of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act (1992).

1. Organisation of Gram Sabha in a village or group of villages.

2. Establishment of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.

3. Direct elections to all seats in panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels.

4. Indirect elections to the post of chairperson of panchayats at the intermediate and district levels.

5. 21 years to be the minimum age for contesting elections to panchayats.

6. Reservation of seats (both members and chairpersons) for women in panchayats at all three levels.

7. Reservation of one-third seat (both members and chairpersons) for women in panchayats at all three levels.

8. Fixing tenure of five years for panchayats at all levels and holding fresh elections within six months in the event of supersession of any panchayat.

9. Establishment of a State Election Commission for conducting elections to the panchayats.

10. Constitution of state finance commission after every 5 years to review the financial position of the panchayats.

Voluntary provisions:

1. Giving representation to the members of the Parliament (both the houses) and the state legislature (both the houses) in the panchayats at different levels falling within their constituencies.

2. Providing reservation of seats (both members and chairpersons) for backward classes in panchayats at any level.

3. Granting powers and authority to the panchayats to enable them to function as institutions of self-government (in brief, making them autonomous bodies).

4. Devolution of powers and responsibilities upon panchayats to prepare plans for economic development and social justice; and to perform some or all of the 29 functions listed in the 11th schedule of the Constitution.

5. Granting financial powers to the panchayats, that is, authorizing them to levy, collect and appropriate taxes, duties, tolls and fees.

Q.49) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: Every Gram Sabha shall be competent to safeguard and preserve the traditions and customs of the people, their cultural identity, community resources and the customary mode of dispute mechanism.

Statement 2 is correct: The reservation of seats in the Scheduled Areas in every Panchayat shall be in proportion to the population of the communities for whom reservation is sought to be given under Part IX of the Constitution. However, the reservation for the Scheduled Tribes shall not be less than one-half of the total number of seats. **Further, all seats of chairpersons of Panchayats at all levels shall be reserved for the Scheduled Tribes.**

Statement 3 is correct: As per the provisions of the Act, Every Gram Sabha shall have the following powers-

- The recommendations of the Gram Sabha or the panchayats at the appropriate level shall be mandatory for grant of prospecting licence or mining lease for minor minerals in the Scheduled areas.

-The prior recommendations of the Gram sabha or the Panchayats at the appropriate level shall be mandatory for grant of concession for the exploitation of minor minerals by auction.



Q.50) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: In 1687-88, the first municipal corporation of India was set up at Madras. The Calcutta and Bombay municipal corporations were set up in 1726. Although Lord Mayo's Resolution of 1870 on financial decentralization visualised the development of local self government, the resolution of Lord Rippon has been hailed as the 'Magna Carta' of the local self government and due to this Lord Rippon is known as the 'father of local self government'.

Statement 2 is correct: The system of urban government was constitutionalised through the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992. It is the governance of an urban area by the people through their elected representatives. At the Central level, the subject of 'urban local government' is dealt with by the following three ministries:

- I. Ministry of Urban Development.
- II. Ministry of Defence.
- III. Ministry of Home Affairs.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The functions are generally differentiated into compulsory and discretionary.

- Construction and maintenance of rescue homes and orphanages are among the discretionary functions which depends on the availability of economic resources. They are amongst the less prioritized works.
- The other discretionary functions are housing for low income groups, organising public receptions, provision of treatment facilities etc.

Q.51) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The act provides for the constitution of the following three types of municipalities in every state.

- I. A nagar panchayat for a transitional area, that is, an area in transition from a rural area to an urban area.
- II. A municipal council for a smaller urban area.
- III. A municipal corporation for a larger urban area.

Statement 2 is correct: All members of a municipality shall be elected directly by the people of the municipal area. For this purpose, each municipal area shall be divided into territorial constituencies to be known as wards. **The state legislature may provide for the**

manner of election of the chairperson of the municipality.

Statement 3 is correct: The state legislature under the Act, may also provide for the representation of the following persons in a municipality.

- I. Persons having special knowledge or experience in municipal administration without the right to vote in the meetings of municipality.
- II. The members of the Lok Sabha and the state legislative assembly representing constituencies that comprise wholly or partly the municipal area.
- III. The members of the Rajya Sabha and the state legislative council registered as electors within the municipal area.
- IV. The chairpersons of committees (other than wards committees).

Statement 4 is incorrect: The act provides for the reservation of seats for the scheduled castes and the scheduled tribes in every municipality in proportion of their population to the total population in the municipal area. Further, it provides for the reservation of not less than one-third of the total number of seats for women (including the number of seats reserved for women belonging to the SCs and the STs).

Q.52) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: According to A-243W, Subject to the provisions of this Constitution, the legislature of a state may, by law, endow The Municipalities with such power and authority as may be necessary to enable them to perform functions institutions of self-government and such law may contain provisions for the devolution of powers and responsibilities upon Municipalities, subject to such condition as may be specified therein, with respect to **the preparation of plans for economic development and social justice.**

Statement 2 is correct: Municipalities have constitutional responsibilities in respect of matters enumerated in Schedule XII of the Constitution, and powers in respect thereof under Part IX-A.

Statement 3 is correct: To review the roles, responsibilities and extent of power that the local municipal bodies envisage, the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs releases the Municipal Performance



Index. It has been launched as an accompaniment to the Ease of Living Index.

Q.53) Ans: C

Exp:

Option 1,2,3,4,5, is correct: Twelfth Schedule contains 18 functional items placed within the purview of Municipalities.

1. Urban planning including town planning.
2. Planning for economic and social development.
3. Roads and bridges.
4. Water supply for domestic, industrial and commercial purposes.
5. Public health, sanitation, conservancy and solid waste management.
6. Fire services.
7. Urban forestry, protection of the environment and promotion of ecological aspects.
8. Slum improvement and upgradation.
9. Urban poverty alleviation.
10. Burial and burial grounds, cremation and cremation grounds and electric crematoriums.
11. Vital statistics including registration of births and deaths.
12. Public amenities.
13. Urban amenities.
14. Regulation of land use.
15. Promotion of cultural, educational and aesthetic aspects.
16. Cattle ponds, prevention of cruelty to animals.
17. Regulation of slaughterhouses and tanneries.
18. Safeguarding the weaker sections of the society, including the handicapped and mentally retarded.

Option 6 is incorrect: Whereas Adult and non-formal education is under the purview of Panchayats.

Q.54) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The following eight types of Urban Local Bodies are created in India for the administration of urban areas:

1. Municipal Corporation.

2. Municipality.
3. Notified Area Committee.
4. Town Area committee.
5. Cantonment Board.
6. Township.
7. Port Trust.
8. Special Purpose Agency.

Statement 2 is correct: Municipal corporations are created for the administration of big cities and have three authorities, namely, the council, the standing committees and the commissioner. The council is a deliberative and legislative wing of the corporation. It consists of the councillors directly elected by the people, as well as a few nominated persons having knowledge or experience of municipal administration. The standing committees are created to facilitate the working of the council, which is too large in size. They deal with public works, education, health, taxation, finance and so on. They take decisions in their fields. The municipal commissioner is responsible for the implementation of the decisions taken by the council and its standing committees. Thus, he is the chief executive authority of the corporation and is appointed by the State Government.

Statement 3 is correct: Like a Municipal corporation, a Municipality also has three authorities, namely, the council, the standing committees and the chief executive officer. The council is the deliberative and legislative wing of the municipality and is headed by a president/chairman. Unlike the Mayor of a Municipal Corporation, he plays a significant role and is the pivot of the municipal administration. Apart from presiding over the meetings of the council, he enjoys executive powers.

Statement 4 is incorrect: Notified Area Committee is created for the administration of two types of areas:-
1. A fast developing town due to industrialization,
2. A town which does not yet fulfill all the conditions necessary for the constitution of a municipality, but which otherwise is considered important by the state government.

It functions within the framework of the State Municipal Act, but unlike the municipality, it is an entirely nominated body, that is, all the members of a notified area committee including the chairman are nominated by the state government. Thus, it is neither an elected body nor a statutory body.



Q.55) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: Under Article 243-X, the Legislature of a State may, by law,-

1. Authorize a Municipality to levy , collect and appropriate such taxes, duties, tolls and fees in accordance with such procedures and subjects to such limits.
2. Assign to a municipality such taxes, duties, tolls and fees levied and collected by the state government for such purposes and subject to such conditions and limits.

Statement 2 is correct: Further the legislature of a State may, by law,-

1. Provide for making such grants-in-aid to the Municipalities from the consolidated fund of the state; and
2. Provide for the constitution of such funds for crediting all money received, respectively, by or on behalf of the Municipalities and also for the withdrawal of such monies therefore as may be specified in the law.

Statement 3 is correct: As per a 243-W, all municipalities would be empowered with such powers and responsibilities as may be necessary to enable them to function as effective institutions of self-government. The state legislature may, by law, specify what powers and responsibilities would be given to the municipalities in respect of preparation of plans for economic development and social justice and for the implementation of schemes as may be entrusted by them.

Q.56) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: Niti Aayog, like that of the planning commission, was also created by an executive resolution of the Government of India(Union Cabinet). Hence it is neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body. In other words, it is a non-constitutional or extra constitutional body(not created by the constitution) and a non-statutory body(not created by an act of Parliament).

Statement 2 is correct: Certain objectives of the NITI Aayog are as follows:-

1. Fostering cooperative federalism, active involvement of states.
2. Formulation of plans at village level, aggregation at higher levels.
3. Special attention to sections at risk of not benefitting adequately from economic progress.
4. Economic policy that incorporates National Security Interests.
5. Feedback for constant innovative improvements.
6. Partnership with National and International Think tanks.
7. Creating a knowledge , Innovation & Entrepreneurial support system.
8. **Platform for resolution of Inter-sectoral and Inter-departmental issues.**
9. State of art resource centre for research on good governance.
10. Focus on technology upgradation and Capacity Building.

Statement 3 is correct: Niti Aayog in collaboration with Mastercard released the report. The report highlights the challenges in accelerating Digital Financial inclusion in India and provides measures for making digital services accessible to its citizens.

Q.57) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1, 2, 3, 4 is correct: The Full time Organizational Framework comprises of;

I. Prime Minister as the Chairperson.

II. Vice Chairman appointed by the Prime Minister.

III. Part-time members from leading universities and research organizations on a rotation basis.(Maximum of 2).

IV. Ex-officio members: Maximum of 4 members of the Union council of Ministers to be appointed by the Prime Minister.

V. Chief Executive Officer appointed by the Prime Minister for a fixed tenure.

VI. Secretariat as deemed necessary.

Statement 5 is incorrect: The Governing council, comprises Chief Ministers of all the states, Chief Ministers of the Union territories with legislature and Lt Governor of other union territories.

Q.58) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The National Development Council was established in August 1952 by an executive resolution of the Government of India on the recommendation of the First Five Year Plan(draft outline). Like the erstwhile planning it is neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body.

Statement 2 is correct: The National Development Council is composed of the following members.

1. The Prime Minister of India(Chairman/Head)
2. All Union Cabinet Ministers.
3. The Chief Ministers of all the states.
4. The Chief Ministers/administrators of all the Union territories.
5. Members of the NITI Aayog.

The secretary of the NITI Aayog acts as the secretary to the NDC.

Statement 3 is correct: The National Development Council was established with the following objectives.

1. To secure cooperation of states in the execution of the plan.
2. To strengthen and mobilise the efforts and resources of the nation in support of the plan.
3. **To promote common economic policies in all vital spheres.**
4. To ensure balanced and rapid development of all parts of the country.

Q.59) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The commission is a multi-member body consisting of chairperson and five members. The chairperson should be a retired Chief Justice of India or a judge of the Supreme Court and members should be a serving or retired judge of the Supreme Court, **a serving or retired Chief Justice of a High court** and three persons(one should be a woman) having knowledge or practical experience with respect to human rights. In addition to these the commission also has seven ex-officio members:-

1. Chairperson of National Commission for Minorities.
2. Chairperson of National Commission for SCs.

3. Chairperson of National Commission for STs.
4. Chairperson of National Commission for BCs.
5. Chairperson of National Commission for Women
6. Chairperson of National Commission for Protection of Child Rights.
7. Chief Commissioner for Persons with disabilities.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Chairperson and members are appointed by the President on the recommendations of a six member committee headed by the Prime Minister;

1. Speaker of the Lok Sabha
2. Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha.
3. Leader of opposition of Rajya Sabha
4. Leader of opposition of Lok Sabha.
5. Central Home Minister.

Statement 3 is correct: The major functions of the commission are to inquire into any violation of human rights or negligence in the prevention of such violation by a public servant, either suo motu or on a petition presented to it or on an order of a court. Other functions include, to intervene in any proceedings involving allegations of violation of human rights pending before a court.

Statement 4 is incorrect: **The commission has its own nucleus of investigating staff for investigation into complaints of human rights violations.** Besides, it is empowered to utilize the services of any officer or investigation agency of the Central Government or any State Government for the purpose. It has also established effective cooperation with the NGOs with first hand information about human rights violations.

Q.60) Ans: B

Exp:

The commission is not empowered to inquire into any matter after the expiry of one year from the date on which the act constituting the violation of human rights is alleged to have been committed.

Section 18 of the Protection of Human Rights Act empowers the Human Rights Commission for the following and The Commission may take any of the following steps during or upon completion of an enquiry:



Statement 1 is correct: It may recommend to the concerned government or authority for the grant of immediate interim relief to the victim.

Statement 2 is correct: It may recommend to the concerned government or authority to make payment of compensation or damages to the victim.

Statement 3 is incorrect: It may recommend to the concerned government or authority the initiation of proceedings for prosecution or any other action against the guilty public servant.

Statement 4 is incorrect: It may approach the Supreme Court or the high court concerned for the necessary directions, orders or writs.

Q.61) Ans: D

Exp:

The Protection of Human Rights Act (1993) provides for the establishment of a Human Rights Court in every district for the speedy trial and violation and abuse of human rights.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Act mentions that the said courts can be set up by the state government only with the concurrence of the Chief justice of the High Court of that state.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Act provides for every Human Rights Court, the state government specifies a public prosecutor or appoints an advocate (who has practiced for seven years) as a special public prosecutor.

Q.62) Ans: C

Exp:

Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Act, 2019 envisaged to make NHRC more inclusive and efficient. The various provisions of the act are as follows:-

Statement 1 is correct: Person who has been a judge of the Supreme Court is also made eligible for appointment as a Chairperson of the NHRC, previously only the Chief Justice of the Supreme Court was eligible for appointment to the post of Chairperson.

Statement 2 is correct: Increase in the number of members of the commission who have knowledge or practical experience regarding human right issues and violation of it, from two to three and out of which one should be a woman.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Reduction of the term of the chairperson and members of both NHRC and SHRCs from five years to three years. Also, there is addition of a new provision that made them eligible for re-appointment.

Statement 4 is correct: It provided that the Secretary-General of the National Human Rights Commission shall exercise all administrative and financial powers (except Judicial functions and the power to make regulations), subject to control of the chairperson.

Q.63) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: Director of the CBI will be appointed by the Central government on the recommendation of a three member committee consisting of the Prime Minister as chairperson, the Leader of Opposition of the Lok Sabha and the Chief Justice of India or any judge nominated by him/her. Later the Delhi Special Police Establishment (Amendment) Act, 2014 made a change in the composition of the committee related to the appointment of the Director of CBI, When there is no recognized Leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha, then the leader of the single largest opposition party would be the member of the committee.

Statement 2 is correct: There shall be a Directorate of prosecution headed by a director for conducting the prosecution of cases under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013. He shall be an officer not below the rank of Joint Secretary to the Government of India and will be appointed by the Central government upon the recommendation of the CVC. He will function under the Director of the CBI and shall hold office for a period of two years.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The central government and not the director of the CBI shall appoint officers of the rank of SP and above in the CBI on the recommendation of the committee consisting of the CVC as chairperson, the Vigilance commissioners, the Secretary of the Home Ministry and the Secretary of the Department of Personnel.

Q.64) Ans: D

Exp:



Statement a, b and c is incorrect: Following are the functions entrusted to the CBI.

1. Maintaining crime statistics and disseminating criminal information.
2. The CBI acts as the "National Central Bureau" of Interpol in India.
3. To coordinate the activities of the various state police forces and anti-corruption agencies.
4. At the request of the State Government, the CBI can take up any case of public importance and investigate it.
5. Investigate crimes of serious nature that have national and international ramifications, and committed by professional criminals and organized gangs.

Statement d is Correct: Acting as an authority to receive information that is related to suspicious transactions under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 is the function entrusted to the Central Vigilance commission.

Q.65) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The CVC was set up by the Government in 1964, after the recommendations of the Santhanam Committee with an objective to advise and guide Central Government agencies in the field of vigilance. The commission was given statutory status by the enactment of "The Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003".

Statement 2 is incorrect: CVC is an independent body responsible only to the parliament, it is not controlled by any ministry or department. It monitors all vigilance activity under the central government and is free from any executive authority. It also advises various authorities in central government organizations in planning, executing, reviewing and reforming their vigilance work.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The CVC is not an investigating agency and has no dedicated workforce to deal with investigation under its wing. The investigation work is either done by the CBI or the Chief Vigilance Officers in the government offices for CVC.

Reference: <https://cvc.gov.in/?q=faq>

Q.66) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: Many states in India even before the enactment of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013) established the office of Lokayuktas. Odisha passed the Act regarding the institution of Lokayukta way back in 1970, whereas Maharashtra in 1971 was the first state to establish the institution of Lokayukta as the act came into force in Odisha only in 1983.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Lokayukta and Upalokayukta of a state is appointed by the Governor of that said state. While appointing, the Governor of the state consults (a) the Chief Justice of the state High court, and (b) the Leader of the opposition of the state legislative assembly.

Statement 3 is correct: There is no uniform set of criteria for appointment, some states like Uttar Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Gujarat, Odisha prescribed for judicial qualifications, whereas states like Bihar and Maharashtra have no such specific provisions. The term of office is fixed for 5 years duration or 65 years of age, whichever is earlier in most of the states across India and the Lokayukta is not eligible for reappointment for a second term.

Statement 4 is incorrect: Non-uniformity regarding the jurisdiction of Lokayukta in all the states can be observed. Some examples are as follows;

- Chief Minister is included within the jurisdiction of lokayukta in the states of Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh, whereas they are outside the purview of the lokayukta in the states of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra.
- Maharashtra included former ministers and civil servants when most of the states didn't.

Statement 5 is incorrect: Power to start investigation on its own is not uniform in all the states in India. The office of the Lokayukta does not enjoy power of suo motu proceedings in the states of Uttar Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh and Assam. Here the Lokayukta can initiate investigations on the basis of a complaint received from a citizen or groups of citizens against any malpractices.



Q.67) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The concerned state High Court has no role to play in the removal of the State Chief Information Commissioner or a State Information Commissioner. The State Chief Information Commissioner or a State Information Commissioner shall be removed from his/her office only by order of the Governor on the ground of proved misbehaviour or incapacity after the Supreme Court, on a reference made to it by the Governor, has on inquiry, reported that the State Chief Information Commissioner or a State Information Commissioner, can be removed on such a ground.

Statement 2 is correct: The Governor may by order remove from office the State Chief Information Commissioner or the State Information Commissioner on the following grounds

- is adjudged an insolvent; or
- engages during his term of office in any paid employment outside the duties of his office; or
- has been convicted of an offense which, in the opinion of the Governor, involves moral turpitude; or
- is in the opinion of the Governor, unfit to continue in office by reason of infirmity of mind or body; or
- **has acquired such financial or other interests as is likely to prejudicially affect his functions as the State Chief Information Commissioner or a State Information Commissioner.**

Statement 3 is correct: The Governor may suspend from office, and if deemed necessary prohibit also from attending the office during the inquiry, the State Chief Information Commissioner or a State Information Commissioner in respect of whom a reference has been made in the Supreme Court.

Q.68) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The Central Information Commission was constituted with effect from 12th October 2005 under the Right to Information Act 2005 to act upon the complaints received from individuals who are unable to get help from the Central Public Information Officer or State Public Information Officer due to reasons like refusal from the competent

authority under RTI Act or non availability of the officer of the competent authority.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The commissioners are appointed by the President on the recommendations of a committee consisting of the Prime Minister as the chairperson, the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha, and a union cabinet minister nominated by the Prime Minister.

Statement 3 is correct: The commission has the power to examine any record under the control of the public authority. All such records shall be made available to the commission during the examination. During inquiries the CIC has the powers of a civil court and submits an annual report to the Government of India a report on the progress of the Act.

Q.69) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct and statement 4 is incorrect: Articles 371 to 371-J in Part XXI of the constitution contain special provisions for 12 states viz., Maharashtra, Gujarat, Nagaland, Assam, Manipur, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Sikkim, Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh, Goa and Karnataka. The objective is

- to meet the aspirations of the people of backward regions of the states.
- to protect the cultural and economic interests of the tribal people of the states.
- to deal with the disturbed law and order condition in some part of the state
- to protect the interest of the local people of the state.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Originally the constitution did not make any special provisions for these states. They have been incorporated by the various subsequent amendments made in the context of reorganization of the states or conferment of statehoods on the Union Territories.

Statement 3 is correct: Under Article 371 the President is authorized to provide the Governor with special responsibility. For example, Governor of Maharashtra and Gujarat would have special responsibility for the establishment of separate development boards for -
I. Vidarbha, Marathwada and the rest of Maharashtra.
II. Saurashtra, Kutch and the rest of Gujarat.



Q.70) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The President may appoint the Governor of a state as the administrator of an adjoining Union territory, and where a Governor is so appointed, he shall exercise his functions as such administrator independently of his council of ministers.

Statement 2 is correct: Article 239AA of the constitution vests the power in the administrator to express his or her disagreement and refer the matter to the President and act accordingly. This results in tussle between the constitutional head and the democratically elected government of the union territories with legislature.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Union territories are administered by the President through an administrator appointed by him. The President can specify the designation of an administrator; it may be Lieutenant Governor or Chief Commissioner or Administrator. Administrator of a Union territory is an agent of the Central Government and is not a constitutional head of state like a Governor.

Q.71) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Both the statements are correct:**
 - Banks Board Bureau is an **Autonomous Body of Government of India**. It is committed to **improving the Governance and Boards of public sector financial institutions**. The Secretariat of the Bureau currently comprises a Secretary and three officers.
 - It was set under the **recommendations of the RBI-appointed Nayak Committee** as part of the **Indradhanush Plan**.
 - The **Central Government notified the amendment to the Nationalised Banks (Management and Miscellaneous Provisions) Scheme, 1980** providing the **legal framework for composition and functions of the Banks Board Bureau** on March 23, 2016. The Bureau accordingly started

functioning from April 01, 2016 as an autonomous recommendatory body.

NEWS: [Banks Board Bureau | An Autonomous Body of Government of India](#)

Q.72) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - The electoral bonds are available for purchase by **any person** (who is a **citizen** of India or **incorporated** or **established** in India) for a period of ten days each in the months of January, April, July and October as may be specified by the Central Government.
 - Earlier, **only profit-making domestic companies could contribute to political parties**; now **loss-making companies can too**. Earlier, **foreign companies** or companies where the controlling stake was held by a foreign company couldn't contribute; **now they can**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:**
 - Earlier, A firm could donate a **maximum of 7.5 percent of its average three year net profit** as political donations according to Section 182 of the Companies Act. As per the same section of the Act, companies had to disclose details of their political donations in their annual statement of accounts.
 - The scheme ensures that this **provision would not be applicable** to companies in case of electoral bonds. Thus, Indian, foreign and even shell companies can now donate to political parties without having to inform anyone of the contribution.

NEWS: [Opacity rules: The Hindu Editorial on how electoral bonds undermines voters' right to know about political funding](#)

Q.73) Ans: A

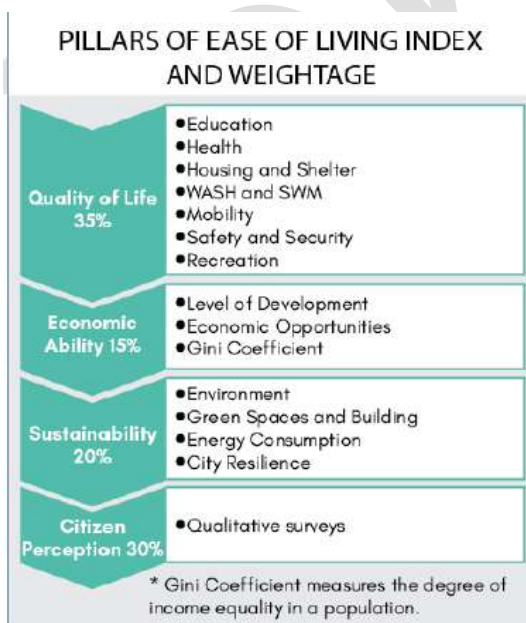
Exp:

- **Option A is correct:**
 - The Faith for Rights initiative was launched by the **United Nations Office of the High Commissioner of Human Rights** (leading UN entity on human rights established by the UN General Assembly) in 2017 Beirut, Lebanon.
 - It aims to unite religious communities of various faiths to counter discrimination and religiousbased violence through a shared objective to promote human rights and to uphold the freedom of religion or belief. 18 Faith for Rights Commitments were included in "Beirut Declaration " to take concrete action on the **2012 "Rabat Plan of Action "** that laid out religious leaders' core responsibilities in countering incitement to hatred.

NEWS: [Upendra Baxi writes: India must support Faith for Rights, a UN-led movement which campaigns against incitement to national, racial or religious hatred](#)

Q.74) Ans: A

Exp:



- **Option A is correct:**
- **Bengaluru** emerged as the top performer in the **Million+ category**, followed by Pune, in the

Ease of Living Index recently released by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs**. In the **Less than Million category**, **Shimla** was ranked the highest in ease of living, followed by Bhubaneshwar.

- It is an assessment tool by the MoHUA that evaluates the quality of life and the impact of various initiatives for urban development in the city.
- The various pillars under which the rankings are calculated are shown here.

Q.75) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - The **Island Development Agency (IDA)** is an apex body for sustainable development of Islands with people's participation. It comes under the purview of the Ministry of Home Affairs and is chaired by the Union Minister of Home Affairs with the CEO of NITI Aayog acting as its convener. Other members of IDA include Secretary- Tourism, Tribal affairs, home secretary, Secretary Ministry of Environment and Cabinet secretary.
 - The Land Ports Authority of India also comes under the purview of the Department of Border management, Ministry of Home affairs.
- **Statement 2 is correct:**
 - While the **IDA is an executive body**, the LPA draws its mandate from the Land Ports Authority of India Act, 2010 and is hence a **statutory body**. It is headed by a secretary level officer of the Govt. of India.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1701771>

Q.76) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option B is correct**
 - The Central Warehousing Corporation is a Central Public Sector Enterprise under the **administrative Control** of



the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution. CWC is engaged in the business of warehousing, total logistics management and allied activities. Warehousing activities of CEC include storage of foodgrains, agricultural inputs and produce and other notified commodities. Running of container Freight stations and Inland Clearance Depots etc.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1701953>

Q.77) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Options 1 and 3 are correct:**
 - Recently, Indian Oil Corporation Ltd. has entered into a joint venture with Israel-based battery technology startup Phinergy to develop aluminium-air technology-based battery systems for electric vehicles and stationary storage.
 - The aluminum-air battery **consists of an aluminum anode in an electrolyte solution of potassium hydroxide and uses oxygen from air as the cathode.** A selectively permeable membrane **allows oxygen from the air to enter the cell** but excludes gases such as carbon dioxide that would interfere with the battery's function. When the battery is in use, the **oxidation reaction of aluminum plus oxygen plus water produces aluminum hydroxide plus electrical energy**
 - **Benefits** of Aluminium-air batteries over Lithium Ion batteries
 - Because aluminum is a **lightweight metal and the cathode material, oxygen,** does not have to be stored in the battery, an aluminum-air battery is considerably lighter than a comparable lithium-ion battery

- Expected to **offer much greater range of 400 km** or more per battery compared to lithium ion batteries (150-200 kilometres) per full charge
- Significantly cheaper, lighter and more **energy-dense alternative**

- **Option 2 is incorrect:**

- A major **disadvantage of the aluminum-air battery** is that it is not rechargeable. Once the aluminum is consumed, the battery must be replaced, which **means that some sort of battery-swapping station or service** would need to be readily available to drivers. However, the by-product of the **battery's reaction, aluminum hydroxide, is recyclable.**

SOURCE: [Aluminum-air battery technology for electric vehicles - AccessScience from McGraw-Hill Education](#)

Q.78) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option C is correct:**

- The **BRICS Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA)** is a framework for the provision of **support through liquidity and precautionary instruments** in response to actual or potential short-term balance of payments pressures.
- The legal basis for the CRA was signed at **Fortaleza, Brazil in 2014**. It entered into force upon ratification by all BRICS states, announced at the 7th BRICS summit at Ufa, Russia in 2015
- The CRA is generally seen as a competitor to the **International Monetary Fund (IMF) and along with the New Development Bank** is viewed as an example of increasing South-South cooperation.
- The total amount of resources initially allocated to the CRA is set to attain the **US\$ 100 billion dollars mark**. The countries' individual commitments



are: **China** (US\$ 41bi); **Brazil** (US\$ 18bi); **Russia** (US\$ 18bi); **India** (US\$ 18bi); **South Africa** (US\$ 5bi).

NEWS: [1st Meeting of the BRICS Contact Group on Economic and Trade Issues held \(pib.gov.in\)](#)

Q.79) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option C is correct**
- As per recent study, a correlation has been found between the phenomenon "**Quasi-Resonant Amplification**" (QRA) and occurrence of heatwaves in India. QRA is a mechanism which is caused by Arctic warming as a result of global warming. It impacts the amplitude and wavelengths of the Rossby waves and Jet streams that encircle the earth in the higher regions of the atmosphere.
- Research has shown for the first time that **heat waves will occur in India as a result of a QRA**. This QRA mechanism is also shown to be the **cause of 2003 European heatwave, 2010 Pakistan flood and Russian heat wave** and other extreme events affecting human and animal life.

NEWS: [Arctic warming is causing heat waves in India: study - The Hindu](#)

Q.80) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect and Statement 3 is correct**
 - The **World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF)** is an international non-governmental organization founded in **1961** that works in the field of wilderness preservation and the reduction of human impact on the environment.
 - Its stated aim is to "stop the degradation of the planet's natural environment and to build a future in which humans live in harmony with nature."
 - Its establishment was marked with the signing of the

"Morges Manifesto", the founding document that **sets out the fund's commitment to assisting worthy organizations** struggling to save the world's wildlife

- The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) was established in **1948** when representatives of governments and conservation organizations spurred by UNESCO signed a formal act constituting the International Union for the Protection of Nature (IUPN)

- **Statement 2 is correct:**

- The Living Planet Report has been published **every 2 years by the World Wide Fund for Nature since 1998**. It is based on the **Living Planet Index** and **ecological footprint calculations**.
- The Living Planet Report is the world's leading, **science-based analysis, on the health of our planet and the impact of human activity**. Humanity's demands exceed the Earth's capacity to sustain us.
- In addition, WWF has launched several notable worldwide campaigns, including **Earth Hour** and **Debt-for-nature swap**, and its current work is organized around these six areas: food, climate, freshwater, wildlife, forests, and oceans

NEWS: [Switch off lights for Earth Hour: BSES discoms - The Hindu](#)

Q.81) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option C is correct**
- The Ministry of Culture conducted a program involving plenary sessions anchored around GI products of India, artistic displays with GI textiles and spices at the two day Geographical Indication (GI) Mahotsav held in Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration, Mussoorie.
 - A mini exhibition of GI Textiles is on showcase covering a wide range of saris connected to GI textile such as

PatanPatola, Banaras Brocades, UppadaJamdani, Kalamkari, Paithani, Kota Doria, Pochampallylkat etc. and brings alive the exquisite weaving and design traditions of India

- The Programme also saw a choreographed presentation involving various dance forms ,75 artists connected to some of the regions that have GI product linkages across India such as **Purulia Chau** (West Bengal), **KinnauriNati** (Himachal Pradesh), **Rathwa Dance** (Gujarat), **Kashmiri Rouff Dance** (Kashmir), **BrijRas/ Barsanakiholi** (Uttar Pradesh).

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1702491>

Q.82) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**
 - The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) was established by the Government of India under the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority Act** passed by the Parliament in December, **1985**. The Authority **replaced the Processed Food Export Promotion Council (PFEPCC)**.
 - It has been Set-up by the Ministry of **Commerce and Industry, Government of India** and provides the crucial interface between farmers, storehouses, packers, exporters, surface transport, ports, Railways, Airways, all others engaged in export trade and finally to the international market.
- **Statements 2 and 3 are correct**
 - APEDA is mandated with the **responsibility of export promotion and development** of the following scheduled products:

- Fruits, Vegetables and their Products.
 - Meat and Meat Products.
 - Poultry and Poultry Products.
 - Dairy Products.
 - Confectionery, Biscuits and Bakery Products.
 - Honey, Jaggery and Sugar Products.
 - Cocoa and its products, chocolates of all kinds.
 - **Alcoholic and Non-Alcoholic Beverages.**
 - Cereal and Cereal Products.
 - Groundnuts, Peanuts and Walnuts.
 - Pickles, Papads and Chutneys.
 - Guar Gum.
 - Floriculture and Floriculture Products.
 - Herbal and Medicinal Plants.
- In addition to this, APEDA has been entrusted with the responsibility to **monitor import of sugar.**

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1702513>

Q.83) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option A is correct**
- As can be seen in the map, **Patna (25.59 degrees North)** lies **nearest to the latitude (25.29 degrees North)** passing through Chabahar.



NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1702493>



Q.84) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - The **Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)** is a multi-stakeholder global partnership of national governments, UN agencies and programmes, multilateral development banks and financing mechanisms, the private sector, and knowledge institutions. The Prime Minister of India launched CDRI during his speech **at the UN Climate Action Summit** in 2019.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:**
 - It aims to promote the **resilience of new and existing infrastructure systems to climate and disaster risks in support** of sustainable development.
 - **Members:** 22 countries and 7 organisations.
 - **Thematic Areas:** Governance and Policy, Risk Identification and Estimation, Standards and Certification, Capacity building, Innovation & Emerging Technology, Recovery and Reconstruction, Finance and Community based approaches.
 - The **CDRI Secretariat** is based in **New Delhi, India**.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaselframePage.aspx?PRID=1705499>

Q.85) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option A is correct**
- **India and Norway** have agreed to jointly work in the area of marine spatial planning in the oceanic space for the next five years. This is a part of the **Indo-Norway Integrated Ocean Initiative under the Memorandum of Understanding** signed between the two countries in 2019.
- The two countries have decided to extend support for sustainable ocean resources utilisation to advance economic and social development in coastal areas. **The initiative**

known as **Marine Spatial Planning (MSP)** will be implemented by the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** through **National Centre for Coastal Research (NCCR)** for India. In its primary phase, NCCR will develop a marine spatial planning framework for Puducherry and Lakshadweep. These sites have been chosen for the pilot project in view of their setups with unique opportunities for multiple sectors (such as industries, fisheries, and tourism) to flourish.

- Notably, the **World Bank** and the **United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)** have expressed interest in supporting MoES in conducting MSP, a societal-beneficial initiative for India's coastal regions.

NEW: [India and Norway agree to conduct marine spatial planning](#)

Q.86)

Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option B is correct**
 - Farmers in the Chamba district of Himachal Pradesh, keen for new livelihood options to supplement their income from traditional crops like maize, paddy, and wheat, have found a new lease of life.
 - **Cultivation of aromatic plants** has given them additional income. They have extracted essential oil from the **improved variety of wild marigold (Tagetes minuta)** that has been introduced, and the **profit from wild marigold oil** has doubled the income of farmers as compared to traditional maize, wheat and paddy crops.
 - A distillation unit of 250 kg capacity was installed at Parwai village and farmers trained into agro-technology of wild marigold, extraction of oil, packing, and storage of oil started cultivating wild marigold and distilling oil from it. **The extracted oil is being sold at Rs. 9500/kg and used in preparing perfumes and essences by pharmaceutical industries.** The income of farmers which was around

Rs. 40,000-50,000 per hectare from traditional crops have increased to about Rs. 1,00,000 per hectare by cultivation and extraction of wild marigold oil.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1702819>

Question Style

IAS //2019

Recently, there was a growing awareness in our country about the importance of Himalayan nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*) because it is found to be a sustainable source of

Q.87) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Both the statements are correct:**
 - For effective implementation of various schemes and programmes of the Ministry of Women and Child Development, all major schemes of the Ministry have been classified under 3 umbrella schemes viz. **Mission Poshan 2.0, Mission Vatsalya and Mission Shakti.**

Umbrella Scheme	Schemes included
Saksham Anganwadi and POSHAN 2.0	Umbrella ICDS - Anganwadi Services, Poshan Abhiyaan, Scheme for Adolescent Girls, National Creche Scheme
Mission VATSALYA	Child Protection Services and Child Welfare Services
Mission Shakti (Mission for Protection and Empowerment for Women)	SAMBAL (One Stop Centre, Mahila Police Volunteer, Women's Helpline Swadhar Ujjawala Widow Homes etc.) SAMARTHYA (Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Creche, Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana, Gender Budgeting Research)

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1703251>

Q.89) Ans: D

Exp:

- **All Statements are correct:**
 - **NASA and ISRO are collaborating** on developing an **SUV-sized satellite called NISAR**, which will detect movements of the planet's surface as small as 0.4 inches over areas about half the size of a tennis court. The satellite will be launched in 2022 from the **Satish Dhawan Space Center in Sriharikota** (Andhra Pradesh) into a near-polar orbit.
 - The Name '**NISAR**': The name NISAR is short for **NASA-ISRO-SAR**. SAR here refers to the Synthetic Aperture Radar that **NASA will use to measure changes in the surface of the Earth**. It refers to a technique for producing high-resolution images. Because of the precision, the radar **can penetrate**

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1703147>

Q.88) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:**

clouds and darkness, which means that it can collect data day and night in any weather.

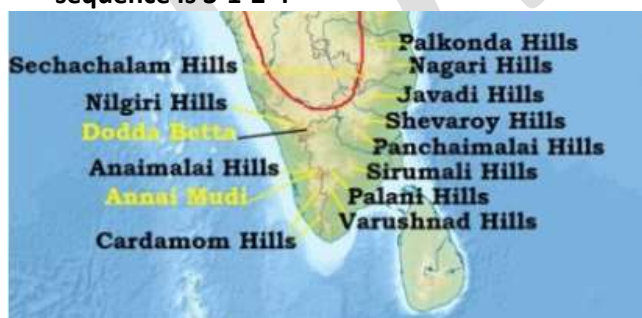
- Primary Goals:
 - Tracking subtle changes in the Earth's surface
 - Spotting warning signs of **imminent volcanic eruptions**,
 - Helping to **monitor groundwater supplies**, and
 - Tracking the rate at which **ice sheets are melting**
- NISAR's data can help people worldwide better manage **natural resources and hazards**, as well as **providing information for scientists to better understand the effects and pace of climate change**. The images will be detailed enough to show local changes and broad enough to measure regional trends.
- As the mission continues for years, the data will allow for better understanding of the causes and consequences of land surface changes. It will also **add to our understanding of the Earth's crust**.

SOURCE: [Societal Benefit | Applications – NASA-ISRO SAR Mission \(NISAR\)](#)

Q.90) Ans: C

Exp:

- As can be seen in the map, the correct sequence is 3-1-2-4



NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1702267>

Q.91) Ans: D

Exp:

Particulars		2017-18	2018-19	2019-20
1	Indigenous crude oil processing	32.8	31.7	29.3
2	Products from indigenous crude (93.3% of crude oil processed)	30.6	29.6	27.3
3	Products from fractionators (Including LPG and Gas)	4.6	4.9	4.8
4	Total production from indigenous crude & condensate (2 + 3)	35.2	34.5	32.1
5	Total domestic consumption	206.2	213.2	214.1
% Self-sufficiency (4 / 5)		17.1%	16.2%	15.0%

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - As can be seen from the adjoining table, the self-sufficiency has actually decreased.
- **Statements 2 and 3 are incorrect**
 - In the last 3 financial years alone, the imported quantity of both LNG have increased consistently.

Financial Year	Crude Oil			Liquefied Natural Gas		
	Quantity Imported (in MMT)	Amount in US\$ (Billion)	Amount in Rs. (Crores)	Quantity Imported (in MMT)	Amount in US\$ (Billion)	Amount in Rs. (Crores)
2017-18	220.4	87.8	56450	20.7	8.05	52122
2018-19	226.5	111.9	783183	21.7	10.25	71867
2019-20	227	101.4	717001	25.8	9.40	67383
2020-21 (April - January (P))	162.8	47.2	340827	20.43	5.77	42708

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1703745>

Q.92) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option C is correct:**
 - The formation of massive stars is currently an unsolved problem in astrophysics. Understanding the formation of massive stars is essential because they dominate the luminous, kinematic, and chemical output of stars. Furthermore, their feedback is likely to play a dominant role in the evolution of molecular clouds and any subsequent star formation therein.



- There are two contending models to explain the formation of massive stars, **Core Accretion and Competitive Accretion**. They differ primarily in how and when the mass that ultimately makes up the massive star is gathered.

- **In the core accretion model**, the mass is gathered in a prestellar stage due to the overlying pressure of a stellar cluster or a massive pre-cluster cloud clump.
- **In contrast, competitive accretion** envisions that the mass is gathered during the star formation process itself, being funneled to the centre of a stellar cluster by the gravitational potential of the stellar cluster.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1704033>

Q.93) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - According to Article 217 of the constitution of India, A Judge of a High Court is appointed by the President after consultation with the **Chief Justice of India**, the **Governor of the State** and the **Chief Justice of the High Court**.
 - According to the various conventions that have been developed over the **3 Judges Case**, the term “**consultation**” with the Chief Justice of India in Articles **217** requires **consultation** with a **plurality of judges** in the formation of the opinion of the CJI. **The sole, individual opinion of the CJI does not constitute consultation.**
 - Accordingly, **In the Third Judges case (1998)**, the

Supreme Court opined that in case of the appointment of high court judges, **the chief justice of India should consult a collegium of two senior-most judges** of the Supreme Court.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:**

- **According to Article 217**, If any question arises as to the age of a Judge of a High Court, the question shall be decided by the **President** after **consultation** with the **Chief Justice of India** and the decision of the **President shall be final**.

NEWS : [President appoints Shri Mohammed Ghouse Shukure Kamal as Additional Judge of the Karnataka High Court](#)

Q.94) Ans: A

Exp:

There has been noticed a global rise of shadow entrepreneurship, in numerous sectors such as **education (certificates), finance (for easy loans), the betting economy (online games) and healthcare (e-pharmacies)**.

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Shadow entrepreneurs are individuals who control a **business that sells authorized goods and services** but they do not list their businesses.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Shadow entrepreneurs do not pay tax, operating in a shadow economy where business activities are executed outside the reach of government authorities. It incorporates different types of businesses such as **unlicensed taxicab services, roadside food stalls and small landscaping operations**. The loose enforcement followed by High tax rates induce **tax avoidance, discourage investment informal businesses**, and drive entrepreneurial activity on the way to the informal sector.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect.** According to the research conducted by Imperial College Business School in 68 countries, found that after Indonesia (not the USA), India has the second-highest rate of shadow entrepreneurs.



Q.97) Ans: D

Exp:

Q.95) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect.** Akash is an indigenously developed **medium-range surface-to-air anti-aircraft defence system** developed by the DRDO as a part of the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Akash missile has the competence to “counteract aerial targets like fighter jets, cruise missiles and air-to-surface missiles” as well as ballistic missiles. It is currently providing functioning with the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** Akash missile has a **strike range of 25 km** and can transport a warhead of 60 kg. Akash can fly at a **supersonic speed** ranging from Mach 2.8 to 3.5 and can target aircraft up to 30 km away, at altitudes up to 18,000 m.

- **Statement 1 and 2 is correct.** It is an integral part of the global waterbird monitoring programme which is known as the **International Waterbird Census (IWC)** coordinated by Wetlands International runs in parallel with other geographical programmes of the International Waterbird Census in Africa, Europe, West Asia, the Neotropics and the Caribbean region.
- According to **Wetlands International (WI)**, Waterbirds are one of the key indicators of wetlands health. Wetlands provide feeding, resting, roosting and foraging habitats for these charismatic species.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** In India, the **Asian Waterbird Census** is yearly organized by the **Bombay Natural history Society (BNHS)** and **Wetlands International**. To obtain information on an annual basis of waterbird populations at wetlands in the region during the non-breeding period of most species.

Q.96) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** The global research team led by the University of Bonn has recognized and further grow novel antibody fragments against **SARS-CoV-2**, the virus that causes Covid-19. These “**nanobodies**” are **much smaller than classic antibodies** — and they, therefore, pierce the tissue better and can be produced more easily in larger quantities
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Antibodies are a salient weapon in the **immune system’s defence against infections**. They attach to the surface structures of bacteria or viruses and stop their replication. One approach in the fight against disease is therefore to produce effective antibodies in large quantities and inject them into patients.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect.** However, **creating antibodies is difficult and time-consuming**; therefore, they are, possibly not suitable for widespread use. Nanobodies are antibody fragments that are so simple that they can be created by **bacteria or yeast, which is less costly**.

Q.98) Ans: D

Exp:

Recently, the Prime Minister paid commendation to Lala Lajpat Rai on his Jayanti. **Every year** Lala Lajpat Rai’s **birth anniversary** is celebrated on the **28th of January**.

Lala Lajpat Rai was one of the extraordinary freedom fighters of India. On 28th January 1865, he was born in a small village named Dhudike in Punjab’s Ferozepur district.

He joined the **Indian National Congress (INC)** and engaged in many political agitations in Punjab. He was against to the partition of Bengal.

- **Statement 1 is correct.** He founded the **Hindu Relief movement in 1897** to provide help to the famine-stricken people and thus preventing them from falling into the clutches of the missionaries. In 1917, he **established the Home Rule League of America** in New York. In the USA, he operates to get moral support for the Indian independence movement from the international community. In 1920, He **contributes to the non-cooperation movement** of Gandhi at the Nagpur session of the Congress.



- **Statement 2 is correct.** In 1921, he also established the **Servants of People Society**. He was leading a silent protest against the **Simon Commission in Lahore**, in 1928, Superintendent of Police, James Scott ordered his police force to 'lathi-charge' at the activist. The police targeted Lajpat Rai, in particular, and hit him on the chest. The confrontation left Lala Lajpat Rai with severe injuries and also led to his death.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** He was also **appointed as a President of the All India Trade Union Congress**.
- **Statement 4 is correct.** He formed the **Lal-Bal-Pal trio** of extremist leaders together with Bipin Chandra Pal and Bal Gangadhar Tilak. He was also involved with the **Hindu Mahasabha**.

Q.99) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect. Indian Pangolin is **scaly anteater mammals** and they have large, protective keratin scales covering their skin. They are the only known mammals with this characteristic.

Out of the **eight species of pangolin**, the **Indian Pangolin** (*Manis crassicaudata*) and the **Chinese Pangolin** (*Manis pentadactyla*) are **found in India**.

Indian Pangolin is widely distributed in India, except in the arid region, high Himalayas and the North-East while Chinese Pangolin is found in Himalayan foothills in Eastern Nepal, Bhutan, Northern India, North-East Bangladesh.

Statement 2 is incorrect. It is also **found in Bangladesh, Pakistan, Nepal and Sri Lanka** and it is placed in **Schedule I of Wildlife Protection Act, 1972** and in IUCN Red List it belongs to the **Endangered category** while the **Chinese Pangolin** belongs to the **Critically Endangered category**. Indian Pangolin is also placed in **Appendix I of CITES**.

Q.100) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect. Monetary policy deal with the policy of the central bank in respect of the use of monetary instruments under its control to achieve the

goals described in the Act. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is entrusted with the **responsibility of managing monetary policy**. This responsibility is clearly mandated under the **Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**.

Statement 2 is correct. The principal objective of monetary policy is to retain price stability while keeping in mind the objective of growth. Price stability is a necessary prerequisite to sustainable growth.

In May 2016, the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Act, 1934** was amended to provide a statutory basis for the enforcement of the **flexible inflation-targeting framework**.

Statement 3 is incorrect. The amended RBI Act also give for the inflation target to be set by the Government of India, in discussion with the Reserve Bank, once every five years.

Consequently, the Central Government has notified in the Official Gazette 4 per cent **Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation** as the target for the period from August 5, 2016, to March 31, 2021, with the upper tolerance limit of 6 percent and the lower tolerance limit of 2 percent.